Can Corporate Partisanship Move Employee Politics? Evidence from Campaign Contributions

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Abstract

Public corporate political stances have become a prominent - and often explicitly partisan - form of engagement, yet we know little about their political spillovers among employees. This paper studies whether stance-taking affects employee campaign contributions, distinguishing between donations to outside political actors and employer-linked channels such as corporate political action committees (PACs). Using hand-collected stance events linked to administrative records on employment and itemized giving, I first estimate a stacked difference-in-differences design with industry- and year-matched controls. Corporate stances increase employee giving on both the intensive and extensive margins, with effects concentrated among ideologically aligned employees. To sharpen inference about mechanisms and moderation - especially for institutionally mediated PAC giving - I field a survey experiment that randomizes employer stance direction across three issue domains and measure behavior using an incentive-compatible $1.00 donation-allocation task. Experimental results mirror the field evidence: aligned respondents increase PAC giving, while misaligned respondents exhibit backlash via increased co-partisan giving. Substantively, the findings reposition the firm as an intermediary institution in democratic politics, shaping not only whether employees participate but where political money flows through organizational channels, with downstream implications for polarization, representation, and firms' role in contemporary democracy.

1 Introduction

Corporate political engagement is pervasive and consequential, but historically it operated largely behind closed doors through lobbying, regulatory bargaining, and political spending (Culpepper, 2010; Drutman, 2015). Increasingly, however, firms have engaged in politics publicly by taking overt—often partisan—stances on salient sociopolitical issues. These stances - for example, running ad campaigns that spotlight divisive racial-justice protests, publicly adopting policies on contraception and reproductive rights, or speaking out on legislation related to sexual orientation and gender identity - create high-salience, time-stamped moments of corporate political communication (Fisch & Schwartz, 2024; Saracevic & Schlegelmilch, 2026). The form of these stances has evolved over time: while the most visible wave of activism between 2018-2022 skewed liberal, firms have more recently signaled partisan commitments by rolling back DEI programs, revising reproductive health travel policies, and distancing themselves from prior racial-justice statements - with the use of "DEI" in S&P 500 annual filings dropping 68% between 2024 and 2025 alone (The Conference Board, 2025). Correspondingly, a growing body of work suggests that such stances can carry real economic stakes, shaping consumer demand, recruitment and retention, and investor responses (Burbano, 2019; Bhagwat et al., 2020; Conway & Boxwell, 2024; Hong & Li, 2021).

Yet despite the inherently political nature of these stances, we know far less about their *political* effects. As partisan identity has increasingly structured market and workplace relationships, stakeholders have become more attentive to where firms stand, and firms face growing pressure not only to speak but to signal commitment to action (Iyengar, Sood, & Lelkes, 2012; Mason, 2018; Gallup, 2025). If public stances function as partisan cues inside organizations, they may reshape political behavior among employees—stakeholders repeatedly exposed to employer messaging and embedded in workplace social contexts (White, Hurst, & Kagan, 2026).

This paper studies one proximate channel of political spillovers: employee political donations. Employees are uniquely positioned as both agents of the firm and civic actors, making them especially exposed to employer political signals (Hertel-Fernandez, 2016). Political donations are a useful behavioral lens because they are consequential, directionally interpretable, and measured with high precision in administrative data (Bonica, 2016). I distinguish between donations to outside political actors and an employer-linked channel—corporate PAC giving—which may respond differently because it is mediated by internal solicitation and contribution mechanisms.

I first estimate the average effect of corporate stances on realized political giving in the field using administrative records on employment histories, party registration, and itemized campaign contributions linked to hand-collected stance events. In a stacked difference-in-differences design with industry- and year-matched controls, corporate stances increase average weekly employee donation amounts by \$0.120 (SE 0.038), a 40.7% increase relative to the pre-period control mean. This increase is concentrated in Democratic-directed giving (0.085 on a baseline of 0.133; 64.2%) and, to a lesser extent, corporate PAC contributions (0.010 on a baseline of 0.050; 20.2%), while Republican-directed amounts are small and statistically indistinguishable from zero in the event window. On the extensive margin, stances raise the probability of donating by 18.8% and the

probability of making a PAC donation by 22.1%. Consistent with a mechanism in which alignment between employee and employer moderates the results, the pooled effects are driven primarily by ideologically aligned employees.

I complement the field evidence with a survey experiment that standardizes exposure and solicitation, enabling sharper tests of alignment-based heterogeneity and the PAC channel. The administrative analysis has a major strength: it captures realized political behavior at scale in the natural institutional environment in which stances occur—high external validity. At the same time, PAC contributions are rare and institutionally mediated by employer solicitation, timing, and measurement, which can attenuate observed responses and limit power for detecting moderation by voter registration. Such observational analysis is thus less well-suited for isolating heterogeneity and specific channels. To mitigate this, the experiment randomizes whether a hypothetical employer takes a partisan stance and, independently, whether the stance is liberal or conservative across three issue domains (abortion, DEI in hiring, transgender equality). The primary behavioral outcome is an incentive-compatible donation-allocation task with real stakes: respondents allocate a $1.00 bonus across partisan organizations, issue-aligned interest groups, the employer's corporate PAC, and the option to keep any portion for themselves. Experimental results mirror the field evidence: aligned respondents increase total giving (and PAC giving in particular), while misaligned respondents exhibit backlash through increased co-partisan giving.

This research contributes to three literatures. First, it advances work on politics in the workplace by showing that employer political signals can translate into observable political participation among workers (Gift & Gift, 2015; McConnell et al., 2018; Colonnelli et al., 2023; Adrjan et al., 2024; Bonica et al., 2020; Hurst & Lee, 2024; Chinoy & Koenen, 2024; White, Hurst, & Kagan, 2026). Second, it speaks to research on how jobs shape political beliefs and behaviors by linking workplace exposure to changes in participation rather than treating political preferences as fixed traits brought to the labor market (Stuckatz, 2022; Malzat & Schmeiber, 2023). Third, it extends the emerging literature on public corporate stances and corporate sociopolitical activism—largely focused on economic outcomes—by identifying political spillovers within firms (Burbano, 2019; Bhagwat et al., 2020; Fisch & Schwartz, 2024; Saracevic & Schlegelmilch, 2026; Conway & Boxwell, 2024).

Substantively, the findings reposition the firm as an intermediary institution in democratic politics. When employers take partisan public stances, they can mobilize aligned employees—especially toward firm-linked vehicles like corporate PACs—while inducing counter-mobilization among the misaligned. Corporate stance-taking may therefore shift not only whether employees participate, but also where political money flows through organizational channels, with implications for polarization, representation, and the political role of firms in contemporary American democracy.

2 Corporate Stances, Employees, and Political Donations

Public corporate stances on sociopolitical issues provide a tractable setting for studying political spillovers from firms to stakeholders.[1] Two features make them useful. First, stances are typically time-stamped, attributable, and widely disseminated, creating a clear before/after moment that can be aligned with stakeholder outcomes (Conway & Boxwell, 2024). This event-like structure isolates a discrete communication shock rather than relying on diffuse, ongoing political activity whose timing and audience are harder to pin down. Second, stances plausibly function as partisan cues. Because they are public, they can become common knowledge, which encourages observers to interpret the firm through a partisan lens (Bullock, 2011). In polarized environments such cues are especially powerful: they compress complex political meaning into a simple signal about the firm's values and priorities, whose behavioral effects are strongest when the stance maps cleanly onto existing partisan divisions (Cohen, 2003; Mason, 2018).

Employees are a natural population in which to study these spillovers. They are not politically neutral inputs into the firm; they are partisan citizens embedded in a workplace where exposure to employer signals is repeated and socially reinforced. Party identification is a durable social identity that shapes how people interpret information and evaluate institutions (Green, Palmquist, & Schickler, 2004), and when a firm takes a partisan stance, employees can read it as a signal about whose values are recognized as legitimate inside the organization. This makes employee reactions conceptually different from consumer or investor reactions, which are mediated primarily through market exchange rather than identity and membership.

Workplaces also amplify partisan cues in ways that other stakeholder environments do not. Labor markets exhibit political sorting, so stances often arrive in organizations that are already politically structured: partisan cues can affect hiring and job choice (Gift & Gift, 2015), workers may value co-partisan employers (McConnell et al., 2018), and politically patterned sorting can yield ideologically distinctive workplaces over time (Chinoy & Koenen, 2024; Colonnelli et al., 2023). Employees may also shape the constraints firms face when engaging politically: employee ideology can discipline corporate PAC strategy, underscoring employees as an internal constituency that firms must anticipate (Li, 2018; Li & DiSalvo, 2023). Together, these features make ideological alignment — whether the employee agrees or disagrees with the stance — the central dimension of response, and make the workplace a natural channel through which corporate political signals may translate into behavioral change.

Political donations are a particularly useful behavioral lens through which to study these dynamics. They are consequential, directionally interpretable, and measured with high precision in administrative data (Bonica, 2016; Schlozman, Verba, & Brady, 2012). Crucially, contribution data allow a clean decomposition of *where* political engagement flows: to the employer's corporate PAC

[1] Research on corporate political activity has traditionally emphasized behind-the-scenes influence through lobbying, regulatory bargaining, and PAC contributions (Hillman & Hitt, 1999; Hillman, Keim, & Schuler, 2004). These channels are widely viewed as consequential, but they pose persistent empirical challenges. Much of the relevant action is internal, and observed spending is often an imperfect proxy for persuasion, access, or policy impact (Ansolabehere, de Figueiredo, & Snyder, 2003).

versus to outside candidates, parties, and interest groups. That distinction separates a workplace-adjacent, firm-linked channel from broader political reallocation in the wider political marketplace (Sorauf, 1984), and it is precisely this decomposition that the paper's theoretical framework and empirical design are built around.

3 Testable Hypotheses

Public corporate stances can plausibly change employee political giving through several mechanisms, but whether giving rises or falls — and where it flows — depends critically on the channel and the employee's ideological alignment with the stance. I organize the paper's predictions around two observable channels: (i) contributions to the employer's corporate PAC, which is a firm-linked vehicle that can function as an approval or affiliation signal, and (ii) co-partisan non-PAC giving — donations to the party-side aligned with the employee's own views — which captures broader political spillovers beyond the organization. Together, these channels distinguish within-firm political affiliation from external partisan mobilization.

3.1 Within-Firm Approval and Political Spillovers

Table 1 organizes the paper's directional predictions. Before reading the table, note its structure: *rows* correspond to the two alignment conditions (aligned vs. misaligned employees), *columns* correspond to the two observable giving channels (corporate PAC vs. co-partisan non-PAC), and each cell contains a primary predicted mechanism — the one that theory most directly implies — alongside a competing mechanism that the empirical design is built to adjudicate. I now develop the logic behind each cell in turn, explaining why theory favors the primary prediction while taking the competing mechanism seriously.

Table 1: Directional predictions by ideological alignment and channel

Employee–firm alignment	Corporate PAC giving	Co-partisan non-PAC giving
Aligned	↑ **Affiliation/Approval** *vs.* ↓ *Substitution*	↑ **Mobilization** *vs.* ↓ *Substitution*
Misaligned	↓ **Withholding** *vs.* ↑ *Persuasion*	↑ **Backlash** *vs.* → *Persuasion/demobilization*

Note: Each cell lists the primary predicted direction (bold) and the main competing mechanism (italicized).

Co-partisan non-PAC giving is restricted to recipients aligned with the employee's own party; cross-partisan giving is excluded as it reflects a distinct set of mechanisms (persuasion, identity conversion) rather than the approval, mobilization, withholding, or backlash predictions organized here.

Aligned employees, PAC channel: affiliation/approval vs. substitution. The corporate PAC is not merely a generic political vehicle — it is organizationally branded and directly associated

with the firm (Li, 2018). Contributing to it therefore carries a specific meaning that contributing to an outside organization does not: it is an act of visible identification with the employer's political posture. For an aligned employee whose views are congruent with the stance, this creates a particularly strong expressive opportunity. The stance signals that the employer recognizes and shares the employee's political values, making the PAC a natural vehicle for expressing approval and affiliation in return (Li, 2018). The theoretical expectation, then, is that aligned employees increase PAC giving following an aligned stance — not simply because they become more politically engaged, but because the organizational channel becomes newly meaningful as an expression of agreement.

The competing prediction is *substitution*: if the public stance itself satisfies the expressive or efficacy motives that would otherwise drive personal donations, employees may feel their own PAC contribution is redundant even while becoming more favorable in attitude (Yildirim et al., 2024). In this account, the firm's stance is a political act in its own right, and contributing to the PAC adds little to what the firm has already communicated on the employee's behalf. Substitution would predict no increase — or even a decrease — in PAC giving among aligned employees.

Aligned employees, co-partisan non-PAC channel: mobilization vs. substitution. For giving outside the firm, the primary prediction for aligned employees is *mobilization*: an ideologically aligned employer cue raises the salience of the issue, validates the employee's existing partisan identity, and makes political participation feel timely and normatively appropriate (Zaller, 1992; Bullock, 2011; Mason, 2018). On this account, the employer's stance acts as a cue that activates latent partisan motivation, producing increased giving to co-partisan candidates, parties, and organizations. The mechanism is not informational — it is not that the stance teaches employees something new about the issue — but identity-expressive: it signals that the employee's political values are shared and legitimate within the workplace, lowering the psychological cost of acting on them.

The competing mechanism is again *substitution*, now operating in the external channel. If the firm's public stance satisfies the expressive demand that would otherwise be met through personal donations to outside organizations, aligned employees may actually reduce outside giving even as they become more supportive in attitude — the firm has, in a sense, "donated on their behalf." Substitution would predict a decrease in co-partisan non-PAC giving that offsets any PAC increase. If approval flows through the PAC and mobilization flows through co-partisan giving, we would expect both to increase among aligned employees. If substitution is operating in the co-partisan channel, we would expect a negative co-partisan intensive margin effect even while the PAC extensive margin increases.

Misaligned employees, PAC channel: withholding vs. persuasion. For misaligned employees, the primary prediction in the PAC channel is *withholding*: donating to the employer's PAC following a dissonant stance would read as an act of endorsement for a political posture the employee rejects. The same affiliation logic that makes PAC giving expressive for aligned employees makes it costly for misaligned ones. A misaligned employee who continues to give to the firm's PAC after a stance they disagree with is, in effect, financing a political signal that opposes their own values — and,

because the PAC is organizationally branded, that action is legible to others in the workplace as political acquiescence (Hirschman, 1970). Withholding therefore has both an expressive and a social logic: it is a way of preserving political identity and of not visibly endorsing an opposing position.

The competing mechanism is *persuasion*: if the stance is sufficiently credible and the employee's prior attachment to an opposing view is weak, the employer's public stance could shift the employee's underlying beliefs, reduce the perceived dissonance, and leave PAC giving stable or increased. Persuasion is a theoretically meaningful possibility but requires strong conditions — the employer must be perceived as a credible political authority, and the employee must be genuinely movable on the issue rather than merely cross-pressured (Kalla & Broockman, 2018). In a highly polarized environment where partisan identity is deeply held, these conditions are less likely to be met.

Misaligned employees, co-partisan non-PAC channel: backlash vs. persuasion. The primary prediction for misaligned employees in the co-partisan non-PAC channel is *backlash*: interpreting the employer's stance as an identity threat — as evidence that the workplace privileges a political identity that is not their own — misaligned employees respond by increasing donations to causes that reflect their own partisan beliefs (Iyengar, Sood, & Lelkes, 2012; Iyengar et al., 2019). This is an active counter-mobilization: the dissonant cue does not suppress political engagement but redirects it, pushing misaligned employees toward heightened investment in their own partisan side. The affective polarization literature provides direct support for this mechanism: partisan identity is most strongly activated not by congruent cues but by perceived threat from the opposing side (Mason, 2018). A firm publicly aligning with a political position the employee rejects is precisely such a threat, arriving in an environment — the workplace — from which exit is costly and exposure is repeated.

The competing mechanism is *persuasion*: a sufficiently compelling stance could shift misaligned employees toward the firm's position rather than driving them away, reducing rather than increasing co-partisan giving. As discussed above, persuasion requires strong conditions, and it would predict a distinctive empirical signature: not merely a null effect on co-partisan giving, but an increase in *cross-partisan* giving — misaligned employees shifting toward the opposing party.

The two channels together. Read jointly, the four cells generate a two-part theoretical claim. First, the *alignment* of the employee with the stance determines the valence of the response: aligned employees express approval and mobilize, while misaligned employees withhold and counter-mobilize. Second, the *channel* determines what form that response takes: approval flows through the organizationally branded PAC vehicle, while mobilization and backlash both flow through co-partisan giving. This two-dimensional structure — alignment × channel — is what distinguishes the paper's theoretical framework from a simpler account in which corporate stances merely increase or decrease overall political engagement. The prediction is not only that stances move the total level of giving but that they also reshape *where* it flows, and that the direction of that reshaping depends on the ideological relationship between the employee and the employer.

4 Study 1: Differences-in-Difference Analysis of Employee Political Contributions

Study 1 uses administrative data on realized political giving to estimate the average effect of corporate stances on employee contributions in the field. The design has high external validity: it captures actual donation behavior at scale in the natural institutional environment in which stances occur. Its limitation is that it is less well-suited for isolating the two channels identified in Section 3. PAC contributions are rare and institutionally mediated by firm solicitation and timing, which can attenuate observed responses and limit power for detecting alignment- based moderation. Study 2 addresses these limitations by standardizing exposure and solicitation under controlled conditions.

4.1 Data

For this study, I use data on individual-level employment history, individual-level data on political party registration (as a proxy for alignment), and individual-level data on contributions to campaign finance (including interest groups and corporate PACs). I also create a dataset of companies that take liberal stances on social issues. Using this data, I observe the donation behavior of employees who work at a company that takes a public stance and compare it to the donation behavior of employees at relevant "control" companies.

4.1.1 Raw Datasets

I use nationally comprehensive LinkedIn data scraped between 2008-2025, which includes 708 million profiles across 20 million companies globally. The data has only information that individuals share publicly on their LinkedIn pages - similar to a resume. Relevant to this study, individuals report their geographic location, education, and job history.

I also use nationally comprehensive voter file snapshots from 2025 from the vendor L2. These files contain 185 million records nationwide. While the voter file does not record for whom an individual voted, it does track whether they voted and the party with which they are registered. Thirty states and the District of Columbia record party affiliation in their voter data; my analysis is limited to those areas (Chinoy & Koenen, 2025). The primary measure of political behavior in this section is individuals' party registration (Republican vs. Democrat), which is highly predictive of both vote choice and broader ideological placement on a liberal-conservative spectrum (Bartels, 2000; Levendusky, 2009; Abramowitz and Saunders, 1998). At the same time, party registration is a coarse proxy for issue-specific preferences and may introduce measurement error when used as a stand-in for policy attitudes (Therriault, 2015; Baldassari and Gelman, 2008). For instance, even on abortion, a substantial minority of Republicans and Republican leaners report that abortion should be legal in all or most cases (Pew, 2024). To address this limitation, Section 5 supplements the administrative measure with original survey data that directly elicit respondents' issue-specific policy views.

I collect information on campaign finance data from the Database on Ideology and Money in Politics (Bonica, 2023). I merge this with the voter file using a proprietary crosswalk. The DIME data includes individuals' contributions through 2024 to local, state, and federal elections, as well as political action committees and interest groups.

4.1.2 Merging Raw Datasets

To merge the LinkedIn and voter file data, I match on name, location, and inferred year of birth, achieving a match rate of 32.5%. I first assign an individual's reported location in the LinkedIn data to a Census place, county, CBSA, or state (in order of priority). LinkedIn users generally do not report their birth year, so I try to infer it from their high school or college years of attendance, where possible, or from their first reported job.[2]

My merging procedure uses 180 increasingly general rounds of combinations of name, birth year, and geographic identifiers. By "increasingly general," I start with the most granular data and zoom out. I start with Census place level, then county, then CBSA, and finally state. I similarly use increasingly less restrictive criteria for name matches - first exact name and middle initial, then first and last name only, then nicknames. I match birth years within a 10 year window. I only keep profiles that are matched to exactly one individual in the voter file. This leaves roughly 44 million individuals for a match rate of 32.5%.[3]

4.1.3 Dataset on Corporate Stances

I create a novel dataset of corporate partisan stances from 2018-2022. For each year, I begin with the universe of the S&P 500 companies. I limit corporate stances to events that were associated with particular firms, had a clear event date, and which were likely to affect stakeholder perceptions of a firm's social values. I restrict my analysis to events pertaining to abortion and reproductive rights, Georgia's Election Integrity Act of 2021, gun rights, Black Lives Matter, and the events of January 6, 2021. Examples of companies taking a social stance may include executive announcements (given they are acting in their managerial capacity), official press statements, posts on social media, advertising campaigns, etc.

I restrict attention to corporate stances that are liberal-leaning. This choice is motivated by measurement: while partisan registration is highly predictive of broad ideological orientation, it remains a coarse proxy for issue-specific preferences, and misclassification is most likely when individuals are "cross-pressured" (i.e., when party identity does not cleanly map into positions on the specific issues implicated by a stance). In practice, cross-pressures are particularly salient for Republicans on several of the focal issue domains - for example, a substantial minority of Republicans and Republican leaners report that abortion should be legal in all or most cases

[2] In particular, I prioritize (1) high school graduation year minus 18, (2) high school start year minus 14, (3) bachelor's graduation year minus 23, (4) bachelor's start year minus 19, (5) first job starting year minus 23.

[3] Studies that perform a similar match yield match rates between 24% and 44% (Kim, 2025; Chinoy & Koenen, 2025).

(Pew, 2024), meaning that Republican registration imperfectly captures opposition to a pro-choice corporate stance.[4] In contrast, for the liberal stances studied here (e.g., racial justice, voting rights, and reproductive rights), Democratic registration more reliably captures alignment with the stance's implied issue position, reducing attenuation from ideological misclassification in the alignment-based comparisons. This restriction also reflects the empirical distribution of corporate partisanship during the period of interest: corporate political speech and activism from 2018–2022 is overwhelmingly tilted toward Democratic-leaning language and liberal-identified positions, rather than symmetric movement toward both parties (Cassidy & Kempf, 2025).[5]

This restriction comes at a cost worth stating plainly: by limiting the observational sample to liberal stances, the design cannot speak to whether the same mechanisms operate when firms take conservative positions in the field. The estimates therefore characterize employee responses to one directional slice of corporate partisanship, and extrapolation to conservative stance (or to a more recent environment in which firms have signaled conservatism) requires caution. The survey experiment in Section 5 directly addresses this limitation by randomizing both liberal and conservative employer stances, providing evidence that the alignment-based mechanisms documented here are not unique to the liberal direction.

I restrict events to those that have a clear, tractable, record of the public stance (as reported either by a credible news source or the company itself). For the sake of subsequent analysis, I also restrict the analysis to only those companies that have a corporate political action committee (PAC). This funnel results in a sample of 53 events across 39 unique companies.

Firms that take clear public political stances on salient social issues are classified as treated. For each treatment event, I construct a comparison group of control firms that do not take an equivalent public stance. Specifically, for each event I begin with the universe of publicly traded firms in the WRDS Compustat database that share the treated firm's four-digit NAICS industry and are observed in the event year. I then restrict candidate controls to firms that maintain a corporate PAC and have no record of taking a public stance on the focal issue during the relevant period.

4.1.4 Sample construction and characteristics

To merge the LinkedIn employment histories with the corporate stance dataset, I harmonize firm identifiers across sources. The stance dataset records treated firm names and event dates, while the LinkedIn data record employers as free-text strings. I standardize employer names in the LinkedIn data (e.g., removing punctuation and corporate suffixes, resolving common abbreviations) and use this cleaned identifier to link workers to treated firms and to the set of eligible control firms defined for each event. This yields 594,411 employees employed at either a treated firm or an eligible control firm at some point in the 2018–2022 sample window.

[4] For evidence of within-party heterogeneity on abortion, see Pew Research Center's compilation of public opinion on abortion.

[5] In Section 5, I turn to an experimental design that randomly assigns liberal versus conservative employer stances, which allows me to directly compare employee responses across stance direction without relying on observational variation in the realized stance mix.

For each stance event, I construct a stacked event-time panel spanning 12 weeks before and 12 weeks after the stance date, and I restrict the sample to individuals who are employed at either the treated firm or an eligible control firm *on the stance date itself*. Treatment is assigned at the firm-event level (employees at the stance-taking firm are treated for that event; employees at control firms serve as controls), and event time is indexed in weeks relative to the stance week (with $week_relative = 0$ in the week of the stance). Employees are allowed to move in and out of firms over time, and I track employment at the weekly level, so the panel reflects entry, exit, and job changes within and across firms.[6]

Figure 1 demonstrates the complete pipeline of restrictions to arrive at the final sample of events. Finally, to ensure sufficient statistical power and comparable treated and control pools within each event, I restrict attention to events that meet four minimum thresholds: at least 250 treated employees, at least two eligible control firms, at least 50 treated employee-donors, and at least 50 control employee-donors. After imposing these event-level requirements and the stance-date employment restriction, the final analytical file contains 974,840 employee-by-event observations (reflecting the fact that a given employee can contribute observations to multiple stance events over time) across 29 events (and 19 unique treated companies).[7] A complete list of events included in the subsequent analysis can be found in Table A1.

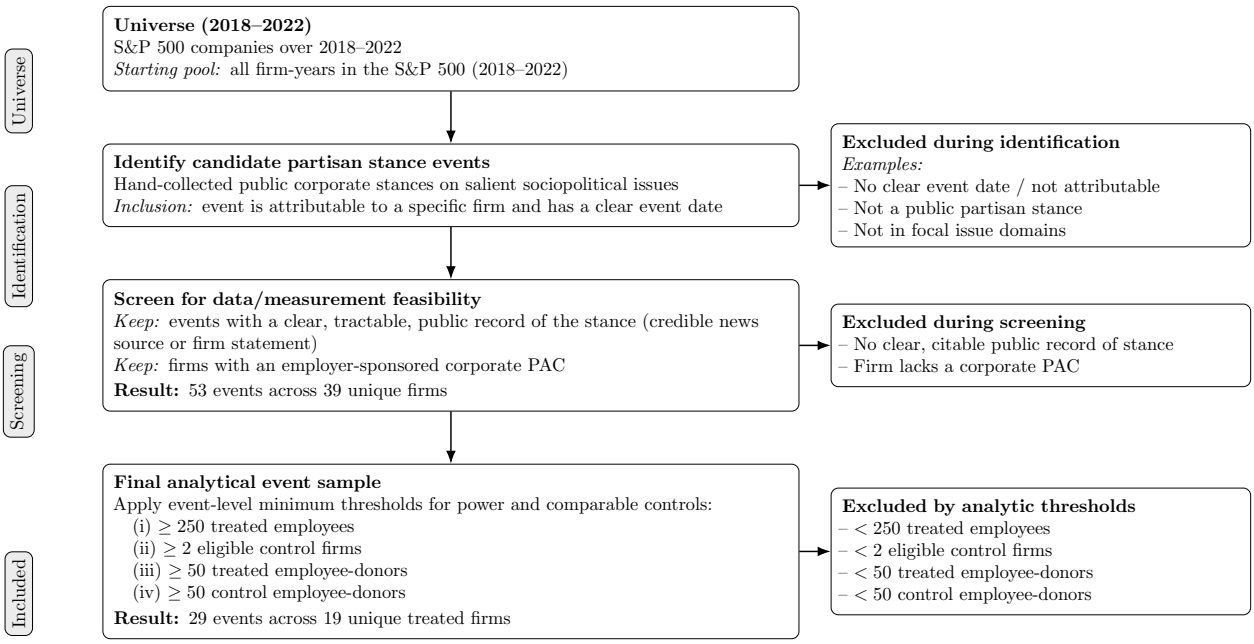


Figure 1: Event-sample construction pipeline for the observational analysis. Various restrictions applied to obtain 29 events across 19 treated firms.

Table 2 reports baseline user-level characteristics for employees at treated firms versus employees

[6]A treated firm is not permitted to serve as a control for other events; and treated employees are not eligible to serve as controls for other events.

[7]Employees can be included in multiple stacks, accounting for the discrepancy between the 569,206 in Table 2 and the N in the subsequent regressions.

at control firms.[8] Across groups, partisan registration and donation behavior are broadly similar in levels, though treated-firm employees are modestly more likely to be registered Democrats (0.466 vs. 0.406) and less likely to be registered Republicans (0.235 vs. 0.298). Donation participation is rare in both groups (about 2–2.5%), consistent with campaign contributions being a right-tail measure of political engagement. Among donors, treated-firm employees are more likely to have donated previously (0.603 vs. 0.519), indicating somewhat higher baseline political activity among employees at stance-taking firms.

Table 2: User-level summary statistics: balance measures (Treated vs. Control)

Variable	**Control**	**Treated**	**Diff (T–C)**	**SMD**
Democrats	0.406	0.466	0.060	0.121
Republicans	0.298	0.235	-0.063	-0.143
Donors	0.024	0.022	-0.001	-0.010
Previous Donors	0.519	0.603	0.084	0.170
Democratic Donors	0.013	0.015	0.002	0.017
Republican Donors	0.007	0.005	-0.002	-0.031
Share Male	0.534	0.572	0.038	0.077
Share White	0.738	0.680	-0.057	-0.127
Share Black	0.104	0.109	0.006	0.019
Share Hispanic	0.104	0.118	0.014	0.046
Share API	0.051	0.088	0.037	0.146
Share HS Degree	0.034	0.035	0.001	0.005
Share Bachelor's Degree	0.370	0.377	0.007	0.014
Share Graduate Degree	0.160	0.180	0.020	0.053
N	174,311	394,895		

Note: Table reports user-level means for employees at treated firms and at eligible control firms (defined within the treated firm's four-digit NAICS industry and event year). "Diff (T–C)" is the difference in means (treated minus control). "SMD" is the standardized mean difference, computed as the treated–control mean difference divided by the pooled standard deviation. "Donors" indicates whether a user makes any itemized political donation in the outcome data; "Previous Donors" indicates whether a user made an itemized donation prior to the event window. Race/ethnicity and education shares are constructed from the LinkedIn data. Counts in the N row report the number of user observations pooled across stacks.

Demographic and education characteristics also show modest differences. Treated-firm employees are slightly more likely to be male (0.572 vs. 0.534) and have higher educational attainment, with a larger share holding graduate degrees (0.180 vs. 0.160). Racial and ethnic composition differs somewhat as well: treated-firm employees are less likely to be White (0.680 vs. 0.738) and more likely to be Asian/Pacific Islander (0.088 vs. 0.051). Standardized mean differences (SMDs) are generally small to moderate, with the largest gaps concentrated in party registration, prior donor status, and API share. These patterns underscore the importance of conditioning on industry and

[8] As described above, the analytical sample is restricted to individuals employed at either a treated or eligible control firm on the stance date for a given event; this table summarizes user characteristics pooled across stacked events.

event timing in the design, and motivate the fixed-effects event-study framework that compares treated and control employees within stacked event windows.

4.2 Empirical Strategy

I estimate the effect of public corporate stances on employee political giving using a stacked differences-in-differences design across 29 instances of partisan corporate statements. Each firm–event defines a separate stack with a treated firm and an event-specific set of control firms matched within four-digit NAICS and event year. The design compares changes in outcomes for employees at treated firms to contemporaneous changes for employees at control firms within the same stack, absorbing time-invariant differences with employee–stack fixed effects and common shocks with calendar-week fixed effects. To account for time-varying geographic shocks, I also estimate a specification with calendar-week × congressional-district fixed effects; the main results in Appendix A.3 remain qualitatively unchanged.

The main outcomes are employee-week measures of campaign-finance activity constructed from itemized contribution records linked to individuals: (i) an indicator for making any donation in a given week; (ii) the total amount donated in that week (winsorized at the 99th percentile); and (iii) donation indicators and amounts by recipient type, including donations to corporate PACs.

Let i index individuals, s index stacks (firm–event pairs), and t index event-time weeks relative to the stance date ($t = 0$ in the stance week). Define $\mathit{Treated}_{is}$ as an indicator equal to 1 if individual i is employed at the treated firm in stack s (and 0 if employed at a control firm in that stack), and let $\mathit{Post}_t = \mathbb{1}\{t \geq 0\}$. The baseline difference-in-differences specification is

$$Y_{ist} = \alpha_{is} + \tau_{cw(s,t)} + \beta\,(\mathit{Treated}_{is} \times \mathit{Post}_t) + \varepsilon_{ist}, \tag{1}$$

where α_{is} are individual-by-stack fixed effects and $\tau_{cw(s,t)}$ are calendar-week time fixed effects common within stack. The calendar-week fixed effects absorb national shocks and seasonality in giving, while the individual-by-stack fixed effects absorb all time-invariant differences between treated and control individuals within a stack. Standard errors are clustered by stack.[9]

The estimated sample is defined by employment at the stance date: any individual employed at a treated for control firm on the date of the stance is included in the panel for the entire duration, regardless of whether they remain employed throughout the window. The total donation estimates are therefore intent-to-treat (ITT) effects of exposure to a corporate stance, and I argue this is the appropriate estimand given the paper's theoretical mechanism. The treatment of interest is a discrete, high-salience public communication - a cue whose effects need not require continued employment to persist.[10] For PAC outcomes, the sample is additionally restricted to weeks in

[9] Clustering by stack allows the error term to be arbitrarily correlated across employees and weeks within the same event window—for example, due to unobserved firm-level shocks, contemporaneous media attention, or issue-specific news that jointly affect all employees linked to a given stance event and its matched control set. This is the relevant correlation structure for inference in the stacked design: observations within a stack share the same treatment timing, the same control-group construction, and potentially common unobserved determinants of political giving.

[10] Indeed, conditioning on sustained employment would risk excluding some of the most politically activated responses:

which the individual is actively employed at the relevant firm, since eligibility to contribute to an employer-sponsored PAC requires current employment. This restriction is substantively appropriate rather than a limitation: PAC giving is by definition a within-employment behavior, and the contrast between ITT total-donation estimates and the active-employment PAC estimates helps distinguish the firm-linked channel from broader political spillovers.

Identification of β relies on a within-stack parallel-trends assumption: absent the stance, treated and control employees would have experienced the same counterfactual change in political giving over event time, conditional on fixed effects. This is the standard identifying condition in DiD applications: the causal effect is recovered by comparing changes over time for treated units to changes over time for control units, after differencing out fixed effects. In my setting, the assumption is made more plausible by (i) constructing control pools within the treated firm's four-digit NAICS industry and event year, (ii) excluding control firms that take an equivalent stance on the focal issue during the relevant window, and (iii) restricting the estimation sample to individuals who are employed at either the treated firm or an eligible control firm on the stance date itself. In Appendix A.2, I show that estimates obtained from a modified Granger causality test are indeed consistent with the null hypothesis of no differential pretrends (Angrist & Pischke, 2008).

4.3 Results from Empirical Analysis

In general, employees that work for a firm that takes a public stance increase their donations to campaign finances. Moreover, aligned employees increase their donations more relative to misaligned employees. These findings underscore that corporate partisanship has the power to affect subsequent employee political behavior.

Table 3 reports the main difference-in-differences estimates. To facilitate interpretation, I report baseline means from the pre-period control group and percent changes relative to that baseline. Exposure to a corporate stance increases employee political giving on both margins. On the intensive margin (Panel A), the estimated Post $\times$ Treated effect on total donation amounts is \$0.120 (SE 0.038), a 40.7% increase relative to the pre-period control mean. The increase is concentrated in Democratic-directed giving (\$0.085 on a baseline of \$0.133; 64.2%) and, to a lesser extent, corporate PAC contributions (\$0.010 on a baseline of \$0.050; 20.2%). Republican-directed amounts are small and statistically indistinguishable from zero. On the extensive margin (Panel B), stances raise the probability of donating at all by 18.8% and the probability of making a PAC donation by 22.1%, with small statistically detectable increases across both Democratic and Republican recipients. Together, the two panels indicate that stances primarily shift the level and partisan direction of giving on the intensive margin — toward Democratic organizations — while also inducing modest participation increases across the board.

Because the empirical design stacks multiple firm–event windows, a natural concern is that the

an employee who quits following a misaligned stance is arguably among those most affected by it, and restricting to stayers would selectively drop such cases from the treated group, potentially biasing estimates upward among aligned employees.

Table 3: Main results: intensive and extensive margins

Panel A: Intensive margin (amounts)				
Dependent Variables:	Total donation amount	PAC amount	Amount to Dem orgs	Amount to Rep orgs
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
Post x Treated	0.1201***	0.0101**	0.0852**	0.0129
	(0.0380)	(0.0045)	(0.0335)	(0.0158)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.295189	0.050055	0.132694	0.084851
Percent change from baseline	40.68	20.16	64.19	15.24
Fixed-effects				
Employee-Stack	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Calendar Week	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	24,371,000	23,696,223	24,371,000	24,371,000
Employee-Events	974,840	974,840	974,840	974,840
R^2	0.14550	0.09232	0.14482	0.11932

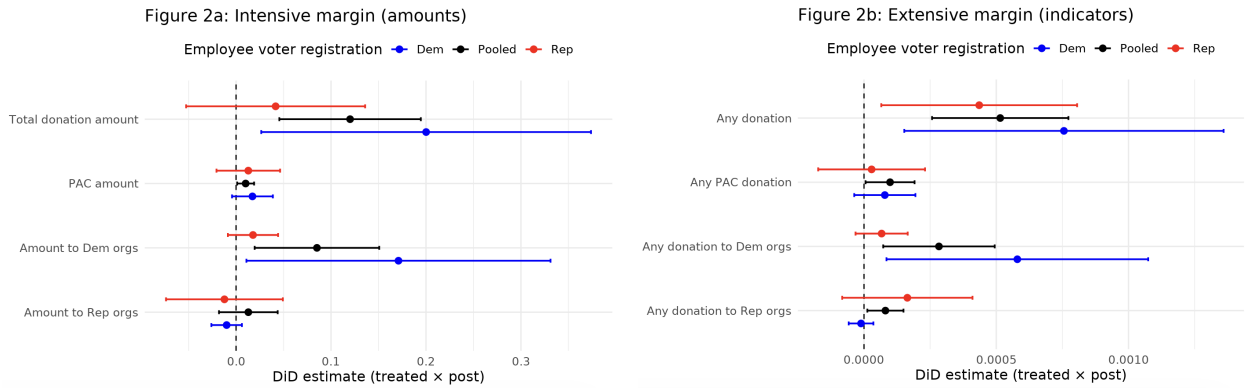
Panel B: Extensive margin (any/indicator)				
Dependent Variables:	Any donation	Any PAC donation	Any donation to Dem orgs	Any donation to Rep orgs
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
Post x Treated	0.0005***	9.85×10^{-5}**	0.0003**	8.09×10^{-5}**
	(0.0001)	(4.73×10^{-5})	(0.0001)	(3.48×10^{-5})
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.002747	0.000446	0.001437	0.000538
Percent change from baseline	18.75	22.07	19.72	15.04
Fixed-effects				
Employee-Stack	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Calendar Week	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	24,371,000	23,696,223	24,371,000	24,371,000
Employee-Events	974,840	974,840	974,840	974,840
R^2	0.27555	0.28670	0.25618	0.27838

Clustered (stack) standard-errors in parentheses
*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

pooled estimates might be driven by a small number of particularly influential events. To assess this, Appendix A.4 reports event-level meta-analytic summaries of stack-specific estimates, and Appendix A.5 presents leave-one-out diagnostics that re-estimate the pooled effect excluding each event in turn. Together, these analyses indicate that the headline results are not driven by any single event and are broadly consistent across the event sample.

Figure 2 decomposes the estimated treatment effects by partisan registration, which serves as a proxy for ideological alignment with the liberal stances in this sample. The pooled effects are driven largely by Democratic-registered employees, who exhibit sizable increases in total amounts and Democratic-directed giving. Republican-registered employees respond weakly on the intensive margin — particularly for Democratic- directed giving — with smaller and less precisely estimated participation effects on the extensive margin. This pattern is consistent with the two-channel framework developed in Section 3: aligned employees (Democrats) mobilize and direct giving toward co-partisan recipients, while misaligned employees (Republicans) show limited evidence of either engagement or backlash within the observational event window. The absence of a strong PAC signal for either subgroup in the administrative data is consistent with the institutional mediation concerns

noted above and motivates the sharper PAC test in Study 2.



Intensive margin

Extensive margin

Figure 2: Heterogeneity results by alignment

The administrative analysis establishes that corporate stances shift employee political giving in the field, with effects concentrated among ideologically aligned employees. Two limitations motivate a complementary experimental test. First, the observational design is restricted to liberal stances, so the results speak to one directional slice of corporate partisanship. Second, and more importantly, the PAC channel is institutionally mediated in ways that are difficult to standardize in administrative data: firms vary in whether and how they solicit PAC contributions, and the rarity of PAC donations limits statistical power for detecting alignment-based moderation. Study 2 addresses both limitations by randomly assigning both liberal and conservative stances, and by presenting all respondents with a standardized PAC giving opportunity under controlled conditions.

5 Study II: Survey Experiment

In this experiment, I randomize whether a hypothetical employer takes a political stance and, independently, the ideological slant of that stance to gain causal leverage on both average effects and alignment-based heterogeneity.

Study I leverages observational data to recover realized political behavior in the field, offering high external validity about how employees respond to actual corporate stances. However, observational designs have limited power for estimating moderation by ideological alignment, and some channels—especially corporate PAC giving—are institutionally mediated by firm solicitation and timing, which can be difficult to observe and standardize in administrative data. Study II therefore complements the field analysis with a survey experiment that randomizes exposure to a hypothetical employer stance and standardizes the informational environment and (where relevant) PAC solicitation. This setting provides high internal validity and is well-suited to testing heterogeneous treatment effects by partisan alignment, as well as isolating the PAC channel under controlled exposure.

5.1 Sampling method and respondent characteristics

I fielded the survey through Verasight in June 2025 to a U.S. adult sample of 1,300 respondents designed to approximate national representativeness. Verasight recruits respondents using a hybrid, multi-modal approach that combines probability and non-probability methods and emphasizes respondent verification and direct recruitment.

To align the experiment with the population observed in the administrative employment and donation data, I define an "analytical sample" that restricts respondents to those age 25+, registered to vote, and either employed or actively seeking work (Chinoy & Koenen, 2025). This restriction yields 842 respondents. Table B1 summarizes the full sample and analytical sample; the analytical restriction primarily shifts the age distribution and labor-force attachment by construction, while other observable characteristics remain broadly similar.

Before describing the experimental treatments, I first measure respondents' pre-treatment attitudes toward each focal issue, which later allow me to examine heterogeneity by issue-specific alignment. As is common in online survey recruitment, respondents are modestly more Democratic-leaning and more supportive of liberal positions on the focal issues than population benchmarks; Appendix B.1 provides additional detail, including issue-attitude distributions and comparisons to Pew.

Two patterns are apparent. First, supportive views are modal across all three issues, consistent with the liberal tilt documented in Table B2. In all experimental analyses, I therefore apply survey weights to align marginal distributions on key covariates, including party identification.[11] Second, the sample nonetheless contains meaningful minority shares of respondents who are opposed (and, for each issue, a nontrivial neutral group), providing variation to study heterogeneous treatment responses by baseline attitudes and partisan alignment.

5.2 Experimental Design

Respondents evaluate a hypothetical large employer across three policy domains in which firms have recently engaged in public political speech: abortion and reproductive rights, DEI in hiring, and transgender equality. Before exposure to the employer vignettes, I elicit respondents' baseline attitudes toward each focal issue, which I use to characterize pre-treatment views and to define issue-specific alignment in heterogeneity analyses.[12]

For each domain, respondents are randomly assigned to read one of three vignettes in which the employer (i) publicly supports the policy (liberal stance), (ii) publicly opposes the policy (conservative stance), or (iii) remains neutral and declines to take a stance. The vignette text is designed to hold constant salience and format across conditions and to make the stance consequential, so that treatment variation reflects the direction of the stance rather than differences in presentation. The ordering of the treatment group was randomized. In Appendix B.6, I confirm that there are no ordering effects affecting the results.

[11] More information on weighting can be found in AppendixB.2.

[12] Respondents' issue-specific feelings are on a 7-point scale ranging from -3 (very opposed) to 3 (very in favor).

The primary behavioral outcome is a donation-allocation task with real monetary stakes: respondents allocate a $1 bonus across a menu of political recipients that includes partisan organizations, issue-aligned interest groups, and the employer's corporate PAC, with the option to keep any portion for themselves. Because the budget constraint is binding at $1.00, intensive margin estimates should be interpreted as measures of proportional reallocation across political recipients rather than as proxies for real-world donation magnitudes. The extensive margin - whether respondents choose to donate at all, and to which recipients - is therefore the more directly interpretable behavioral outcome. For regulatory reasons, respondents' allocations are not transmitted to political organizations, but all respondents receive the full $1.00 bonus regardless of their choices.[13] A key innovation of the experimental design is the use of real monetary stakes - the donation task captures costly political expression rather than hypothetical intent.[14] For the purposes of analysis, I treat donations to politicians and outside interest groups as spillover giving, distinguishing them from donations to the employer-linked PAC. Donation means across respondent ideology and treatment groups can be found in Table B4.

A central feature of the design is that the main analysis uses a repeated-measures sample in which key behavioral outcomes are measured both before and after vignette exposure. Half of the analytical sample is randomly selected to have outcomes measured pre/post treatment. A second sample is fielded without pre-treatment measures and is used to implement a modified Solomon design that assesses whether repeated measurement induces instrument reactivity or demand effects (Malhotra, Monin, and Tomz 2019).[15] The full randomization procedure and protocol are described in Appendix B.3.

5.3 Hypotheses and empirical strategy

The survey experiment tests two pre-registered hypotheses. First, that corporate political stances mobilize employees into political action relative to a neutral control. Second, that this mobilization is conditioned on ideological congruence between the employee and the employer stance. Additional specifications are reported in Appendices B.10 and B.11.

The theoretical framework in Section 3 generates more specific predictions about where that mobilization flows, organized here by outcome channel. I examine three channels: (i) *Any* donation, on both the intensive margin (amount) and extensive margin (indicator); (ii) corporate *PAC* donation; and (iii) *co-partisan non-PAC* giving, defined as donations to the party-side aligned with the respondent's own views.[16] The three channels map onto three sets of predictions:

[13] Because respondents make allocation decisions for each of the three issue modules, I implement incentive compatibility by telling respondents I will randomly select one issue module for payment at the end of the survey and pay them based on their choices in that randomly selected module.

[14] The donation menu is intentionally stylized but substantively meaningful, approximating the core choice set relevant to campaign-finance participation in a way that is tractable within a survey setting. This structure also helps separate donations that directly benefit the firm (corporate PAC giving) from political spillovers.

[15] See Appendix B.7 for a full discussion of the modified Solomon test performed.

[16] Outcomes on the intensive margin are winsorized at the 99% level. Co-partisan non-PAC giving is Democratic giving for liberal respondents and Republican giving for conservative respondents.

H1 (Any giving): If corporate stances mobilize employees into political action, partisan stances should increase total giving relative to the control condition. This should hold for both aligned and misaligned respondents, since both groups are exposed to a salient partisan cue from their employer — the mechanism differs but the direction on any giving is the same.

H2 (PAC giving): The approval and withdrawal predictions operate most directly through the employer's PAC. Aligned employees, whose views match the employer stance, should become more willing to support the firm's political vehicle, predicting a positive alignment gradient on PAC giving. Misaligned employees, by contrast, face a conflict between organizational loyalty and partisan identity; the withdrawal prediction implies they should reduce PAC giving as misalignment intensifies.

H3 (Co-partisan non-PAC giving): If mobilization among aligned employees is cue-driven, it should flow toward their own partisan side as well as the PAC, predicting a positive alignment gradient on co-partisan giving. For misaligned employees, the backlash prediction implies that the dissonance of an employer stance activates partisan identity, increasing donations to their own side even as they withhold from the PAC.

Main specification (Table 4). The experiment uses a two-period within-respondent design. For respondents assigned to the pre/post arm, I elicit baseline outcomes ($t = 0$), present a randomized employer-stance vignette, and re-elicit outcomes ($t = 1$). Let Y_{tij} denote an outcome for respondent i, issue j, at time $t \in \{0, 1\}$, and let $\text{Post}_t = \mathbb{1}\{t = 1\}$. I operationalize ideological congruence as two continuous intensity variables: $\text{AlignedIntensity}_{ij} \in \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$ equals zero for control or misaligned respondents and increases with the strength of agreement between the respondent's views and the employer stance; $\text{MisalignedIntensity}_{ij} \in \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$ is the analogous measure for disagreement.[17] I estimate:

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{tij} \;=\; & \alpha_i \;+\; \gamma_j \;+\; \beta_1 \,\text{Post}_t \\ & +\; \beta_2\big(\text{Post}_t \times \text{AlignedIntensity}_{ij}\big) \\ & +\; \beta_3\big(\text{Post}_t \times \text{MisalignedIntensity}_{ij}\big) \;+\; \varepsilon_{tij}, \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

where α_i are respondent fixed effects, γ_j are issue fixed effects, standard errors are clustered by respondent. H1 predicts $\beta_2 > 0$ and $\beta_3 > 0$ on *Any* giving. H2 predicts $\beta_2 > 0$ and $\beta_3 < 0$ on *PAC* giving. H3 predicts $\beta_2 > 0$ and $\beta_3 > 0$ on *co-partisan non-PAC* giving.

Heterogeneity by stance direction (Table 5). Equation 2 pools liberal and conservative stances through the alignment intensity variables. To assess whether the approval, withdrawal, and backlash mechanisms are symmetric across stance directions, I estimate a specification that separates the alignment gradient by stance arm. Here I replace the two intensity variables with a single continuous

[17] Both variables are derived from the `feel` variable on a $\{-3, \ldots, 3\}$ scale: $\text{AlignedIntensity}_{ij} = \max(\texttt{feel}_i \times \text{StanceDir}_j, 0)$ and $\text{MisalignedIntensity}_{ij} = \max(-\texttt{feel}_i \times \text{StanceDir}_j, 0)$, where $\text{StanceDir}_j \in \{-1, +1\}$. The control arm serves as the omitted baseline.

Alignment measure, defined as $\text{Alignment}_{ij} = \texttt{feel}_i \times \text{StanceDir}_j \in \{-3, \ldots, 3\}$, where -3 indicates the strongest possible misalignment and $+3$ the strongest possible alignment.[18] I estimate:

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{tij} \;=\; & \alpha_i \;+\; \gamma_j \;+\; \beta_1 \,\text{Post}_t \\ & +\; \beta_2\big(\text{Post}_t \times \text{Liberal}_j\big) \;+\; \beta_3\big(\text{Post}_t \times \text{Conservative}_j\big) \\ & +\; \beta_4\big(\text{Post}_t \times \text{Liberal}_j \times \text{Alignment}_{ij}\big) \\ & +\; \beta_5\big(\text{Post}_t \times \text{Conservative}_j \times \text{Alignment}_{ij}\big) \;+\; \varepsilon_{tij}. \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

Outcomes are decomposed into Democratic- and Republican-directed giving, which allows a direct test of whether partisan money flows toward the co-partisan side under each stance. Symmetry of the underlying mechanism predicts that β_4 and β_5 should operate in analogous directions for both PAC and partisan giving regardless of whether the employer stance is liberal or conservative.

5.4 Survey Experiment Results

The results proceed in two steps. Table 4 tests H1–H3 jointly by estimating the alignment gradient across all three outcome channels. Table 5 then asks whether those patterns are symmetric across liberal and conservative stances.

Before turning to the results, one interpretive note on the intensive margin is warranted. Because the donation task allocates a fixed \$1.00 budget across recipients, intensive margin estimates measure *proportional reallocation* across political channels rather than real-world donation magnitudes — a coefficient of, say, 4.0 represents four cents of the \$1.00 budget rather than four dollars. The constrained budget also means that intensive margin effects are inherently bounded, and that increases in one channel can partly reflect decreases in others (including keeping the money). For these reasons, the extensive margin — whether respondents choose to donate at all, and to which recipients — is often the more directly interpretable behavioral outcome, and I give it particular emphasis in the discussion below. That said, the intensive margin retains meaningful information about the *direction* and *relative strength* of reallocation across channels, and the real monetary stakes ensure that allocations reflect genuine preferences rather than hypothetical intent.[19]

Alignment channels mobilization into PAC giving and backlash into co-partisan giving. Table 4 reports Equation 2 estimated separately for three outcome channels — any giving, PAC giving, and co-partisan non-PAC giving — on both margins. Three patterns stand out.

H1: stances increase total giving. The Post × Aligned Intensity and Post × Misaligned Intensity coefficients are both positive and significant on the any giving margin, confirming that partisan

[18] This is equivalent to the difference between `AlignedIntensity` and `MisalignedIntensity`, and collapses both dimensions into a single signed scale for ease of interpretation within each stance arm.

[19] This interpretation is corroborated by an anonymity moderation test reported in Appendix B.9. Half of respondents were told donations would be made anonymously; half were not. Intensive margin effects are attenuated in the anonymous condition, consistent with some expressive reallocation within the constrained budget. Extensive margin effects — whether respondents donate at all and to which channels — are robust across both conditions, supporting the inference that the binary participation decisions reflect genuine preferences.

Table 4: Unified results (H1–H3): mobilization, approval, and backlash

Panel A: Intensive margin (amounts)			
Dependent Variables:	Any Donation	PAC Donation	Co-partisan non-PAC
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Variables			
Post	-3.539^{**}	-0.898	-2.091
	(1.225)	(0.618)	(1.310)
Post × Aligned Intensity	2.198^{***}	2.433^{***}	0.045
	(0.519)	(0.439)	(0.690)
Post × Misaligned Intensity	1.309^{*}	-0.181	1.710^{**}
	(0.539)	(0.256)	(0.643)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	54.568	7.254	43.697
Fixed-effects			
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics			
Observations	2,550	2,550	2,328
R^2	0.798	0.532	0.709

Panel B: Extensive margin (any/indicator)			
Dependent Variables:	Any Donation	PAC Donation	Co-partisan non-PAC
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Variables			
Post	-0.044^{**}	-0.042^{**}	-0.047^{**}
	(0.014)	(0.013)	(0.016)
Post × Aligned Intensity	0.024^{***}	0.057^{***}	0.021^{**}
	(0.006)	(0.008)	(0.007)
Post × Misaligned Intensity	0.014^{*}	-0.011^{*}	0.014^{*}
	(0.006)	(0.005)	(0.007)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.639	0.243	0.645
Fixed-effects			
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics			
Observations	2,550	2,550	2,328
R^2	0.761	0.709	0.704

Notes: Respondent and issue fixed effects included in all specifications.
Standard errors clustered by respondent in parentheses.
Signif. codes: $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

corporate stances mobilize employees into political action regardless of their ideological position relative to the employer. On the extensive margin, each unit of alignment intensity raises the probability of making any donation by 2.4 percentage points ($p < 0.001$), while each unit of misalignment intensity raises it by 1.4 percentage points ($p < 0.05$). The negative coefficient on Post alone reflects a general regression to the mean in the pre/post arm rather than a demobilization effect — it is absorbed once alignment is accounted for.

H2: aligned employees mobilize into PAC giving; misaligned employees withdraw. The Post × Aligned Intensity coefficient is positive and precisely estimated for PAC giving on both margins: each additional unit of alignment intensity raises the probability of making any PAC donation by 5.7 percentage points ($p < 0.001$), a large effect relative to the baseline PAC participation rate of 24.3%. The intensive margin effect points in the same direction — aligned respondents reallocate more of their budget toward the PAC — though this is best interpreted as directional reallocation within the constrained budget. These estimates are most consistent with an *organizational approval* channel: as alignment with the employer's stance intensifies, respondents become increasingly willing to direct giving toward the firm-linked political vehicle. For misaligned respondents, the Post × Misaligned Intensity coefficient on PAC giving is negative on both margins and reaches conventional significance on the extensive margin ($\hat{\beta}_3 = -0.011$, $p < 0.05$), consistent with a *withholding* response.

H3: aligned employees mobilize co-partisan giving; misaligned employees backlash. For co-partisan non-PAC giving, the alignment gradient is positive and significant on the extensive margin among aligned respondents ($\hat{\beta}_2 = 0.021$, $p < 0.05$), indicating that alignment brings new donors into co-partisan giving even as it simultaneously pulls their limited budget toward the PAC channel — consistent with a cue-driven mobilization mechanism operating across channels. The insignificant intensive margin result reflects the budget constraint rather than the absence of an effect. Among misaligned respondents, the Post × Misaligned Intensity coefficient is positive and significant for co-partisan non-PAC giving on both margins (intensive: $\hat{\beta}_3 = 1.710$, $p < 0.01$; extensive: $\hat{\beta}_3 = 0.014$, $p < 0.05$), confirming H3: misaligned respondents respond to a dissonant employer stance by increasing donations to their own partisan side, with the intensity of that response scaling with the degree of misalignment. Taken together, the misaligned results complete the theoretical picture: the same partisan cue that mobilizes aligned respondents toward the firm-linked channel simultaneously drives misaligned respondents toward compensatory counter-mobilization in their own partisan direction.

Heterogeneity by stance direction. Table 5 asks whether the alignment gradient is *symmetric* across liberal and conservative stances. The specification separates Liberal stance × Alignment from Conservative stance × Alignment, and decomposes outcomes into Democratic- and Republican-directed giving, to test whether the same mechanisms operate regardless of which partisan side the employer takes. Throughout, Alignment $\in \{-3, \ldots, 3\}$, where -3 indicates the strongest possible misalignment with the stance and $+3$ the strongest possible alignment.

Two patterns stand out. First, PAC giving is strongly increasing in alignment for *both* stance directions on both margins: Liberal stance × Alignment and Conservative stance × Alignment

Table 5: Heterogeneity by alignment across outcomes

Panel A: Intensive margin (amounts)				
Dependent Variables:	Any	PAC	Amount to Dem orgs	Amount to Rep orgs
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
Post	-2.451	-0.4640	0.2517	-2.239*
	(1.294)	(0.6491)	(1.102)	(1.056)
Liberal stance x Post	1.791	2.751**	-3.260*	2.301
	(1.705)	(0.8518)	(1.382)	(1.466)
Conservative stance x Post	3.390	1.232	0.1260	2.031
	(1.741)	(0.8558)	(1.463)	(1.652)
Liberal stance × Alignment	3.120	5.115***	0.6938	-2.689
	(1.808)	(0.9138)	(1.303)	(1.583)
Conservative stance × Alignment	0.4593	2.044*	-4.243***	2.659
	(1.670)	(0.8210)	(1.207)	(1.545)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	61.292	6.948	35.651	18.693
Fixed-effects				
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	2,328	2,328	2,328	2,328
Respondents	388	388	388	388
R^2	0.79798	0.53765	0.80457	0.73933

Panel B: Extensive margin (any/indicator)				
Dependent Variables:	Any	Any PAC	Any Dem org donation	Any Rep org donation
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
Post	-0.0322*	-0.0429**	-0.0224	-0.0585***
	(0.0146)	(0.0147)	(0.0141)	(0.0153)
Liberal stance x Post	0.0175	0.0682***	-0.0049	0.0223
	(0.0190)	(0.0181)	(0.0168)	(0.0183)
Conservative stance x Post	0.0389*	0.0268	0.0075	0.0481*
	(0.0191)	(0.0170)	(0.0172)	(0.0193)
Liberal stance × Alignment	0.0299	0.1236***	0.0402**	-0.0317
	(0.0192)	(0.0204)	(0.0145)	(0.0189)
Conservative stance × Alignment	0.0100	0.0634***	-0.0305*	0.0506**
	(0.0181)	(0.0165)	(0.0132)	(0.0174)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.711	0.261	0.545	0.376
Fixed-effects				
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	2,328	2,328	2,328	2,328
Respondents	388	388	388	388
R^2	0.76981	0.71304	0.80963	0.77538

Notes: Sample excludes neutral respondents (Feeling = 0). Respondent and issue fixed effects included. Standard errors clustered by respondent in parentheses.
Significance codes: $^{***}p < 0.001$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{*}p < 0.05$.

are both positive and significant for PAC giving ($p < 0.001$ and $p < 0.001$ on the extensive margin respectively). This symmetry reinforces the interpretation that the PAC channel reflects organizational approval rather than a phenomenon specific to one ideological direction. Second, partisan giving shifts in the direction predicted by a cue-driven mobilization mechanism: alignment increases Democratic-directed giving under liberal stances (extensive margin: $\hat{\beta} = 0.040$, $p < 0.01$) and Republican-directed giving under conservative stances (extensive margin: $\hat{\beta} = 0.051$, $p < 0.01$), while moving in the opposite direction for the out-party in each case. The extensive margin is again the more interpretable signal given the budget constraint — respondents are more likely to make a partisan donation at all, not merely reallocating within a fixed pot — which strengthens the inference that these effects reflect genuine mobilization rather than mechanical reallocation. This pattern is difficult to reconcile with a persuasion story and instead matches the framework in Section 3: partisan corporate cues activate and redirect existing partisan identities rather than converting them.

Summary. Table 6 synthesizes estimated coefficients and implied mechanisms across all three channels, and serves as the empirical foundation for the discussion that follows.

Table 6: Estimated effects and implied mechanisms by alignment

Hypothesis		Any Giving H1	PAC Giving H2	Co-partisan non-PAC H3
Aligned	Intensive	2.198^{***}	2.433^{***}	0.045
		(0.519)	(0.439)	(0.690)
	Extensive	0.024^{***}	0.057^{***}	0.021^{**}
		(0.006)	(0.008)	(0.007)
	Mechanism	Mobilization	Approval	Mobilization
Misaligned	Intensive	1.309^{*}	-0.181	1.710^{**}
		(0.539)	(0.256)	(0.643)
	Extensive	0.014^{*}	-0.011^{*}	0.014^{*}
		(0.006)	(0.005)	(0.007)
	Mechanism	Mobilization	Withholding	Backlash

Notes: Coefficients are Post × Aligned Intensity and Post × Misaligned Intensity from Table 4 (Equation 2).
Standard errors in parentheses, clustered by respondent.
All p-values two-tailed. Signif. codes: $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

To read the table, consider what happens to a single employer stance across the two rows simultaneously. Among *aligned* employees, money flows *toward* the firm: PAC giving increases ($\hat{\beta} = 0.057$, $p < 0.001$ on the extensive margin), and co-partisan giving increases alongside it

($\hat{\beta} = 0.021$, $p < 0.05$). The firm-linked channel and the broader partisan channel reinforce each other — the stance both strengthens organizational affiliation and activates partisan engagement more broadly. Among *misaligned* employees, the picture inverts: money flows *away* from the firm (PAC giving falls, $\hat{\beta} = -0.011$, $p < 0.05$) while flowing *toward* their own partisan side ($\hat{\beta} = 0.014$, $p < 0.05$). The same cue that draws aligned employees closer to the firm drives misaligned employees further from it — and simultaneously into oppositional political giving.

Read together, the two rows describe a bifurcation of the workforce's political behavior: a single corporate stance produces simultaneous mobilization and counter-mobilization, with the direction depending entirely on which side of the stance the employee sits. Aligned employees channel resources toward the firm's preferred political vehicle and their own partisan side; misaligned employees channel resources in the opposite direction. The stance does not merely shift the level of political engagement — it reshapes where political money flows. These patterns are symmetric across liberal and conservative stances (Table 5), suggesting they reflect a general property of how partisan corporate signals interact with employee political identity rather than a feature of any particular issue or political moment.

6 Discussion

The results of the two studies converge on a picture that is clean in its broad outlines and precise in its mechanisms. Corporate partisan stances increase employee political giving on average, and that average effect masks a sharp heterogeneity by ideological alignment: aligned employees mobilize toward the firm-linked PAC channel and toward co-partisan giving, while misaligned employees counter-mobilize in their own partisan direction. These findings have several implications for how we understand the political role of firms in contemporary democracy.

Corporate stances operate through partisan identity, not information. The results are difficult to reconcile with a purely informational account of corporate political speech, in which stances shift giving uniformly by raising issue salience or clarifying policy stakes. If salience were the operative mechanism, we would expect increases in giving across the ideological spectrum, not the sharp heterogeneity by alignment documented here. Instead, the pattern is most consistent with a *cue-based* framework: employees interpret employer stances through the lens of partisan identity, and the behavioral consequences — mobilization, approval, or backlash — depend on whether the cue is congruent or dissonant with that identity. Persuasion — the mechanism in which a stance shifts employee beliefs rather than activating existing ones — would predict a different empirical signature: misaligned employees should move toward the firm's position, increasing cross-partisan giving rather than co-partisan giving. The data show the opposite. Misaligned employees counter-mobilize, and do so in proportion to the intensity of their disagreement. This is the behavioral signature of identity activation, not belief updating.

A distinctive contribution of this paper is the identification of corporate PAC giving as a firm-linked channel through which employees express approval or withhold support in response to

employer political signals. Prior work has shown that employee ideology can discipline corporate PAC strategy from the outside (Li, 2018; Li & DiSalvo, 2023); the present findings suggest a complementary inside channel: when firms take public partisan stances, they actively mobilize aligned employees toward the PAC, potentially strengthening the organizational and financial base for subsequent corporate political activity. If this dynamic compounds over time — aligned stances beget more PAC contributions, which fund further political activity, which signals further commitment to aligned employees — it implies a self-reinforcing mechanism linking public corporate partisanship to the internal political infrastructure of firms. The implications for firms depend critically on workforce composition. A firm with a politically homogeneous workforce — increasingly plausible given partisan sorting in labor markets (Frake, Hurst, & Kagan, 2023; Chinoy & Koenen, 2024) — may derive substantial PAC benefit from stance-taking with limited counter-mobilization. A firm with a politically heterogeneous workforce faces a more complex calculus: the same stance that deepens PAC support among aligned employees simultaneously organizes the misaligned minority in political opposition and withdraws their contributions from the firm-linked channel.

Taken together, the evidence repositions the firm as a political intermediary — analogous in some respects to unions, churches, and civic associations, which have long been recognized as organizational channels through which political participation is structured and mobilized (Verba, Schlozman, & Brady, 1995; Hertel-Fernandez, 2016). What distinguishes the firm from these traditional intermediaries is the combination of repeated exposure, imperfect exit, and an institutionalized giving vehicle (the corporate PAC) that can absorb and channel the approval responses that partisan stances generate. As corporate political speech becomes more common and more explicitly partisan, the firm's role as a participation-shaping institution deserves correspondingly greater attention from scholars of political behavior and organizational politics.

The complementarity between the two studies is worth making explicit. Because corporate stances are public events, employees at control firms in the observational analysis are not fully unexposed to treatment: they may encounter the same stance through media coverage, social networks, or industry channels. This represents a potential violation of the Stable Unit Treatment Value Assumption (SUTVA) whose direction is downward — the DiD estimates are best interpreted as conservative lower bounds on the marginal effect of receiving a partisan cue through one's own employer, net of ambient exposure. The survey experiment addresses this directly: by design, control respondents learn nothing about any employer's stance, providing a clean counterfactual that isolates employer-mediated exposure without ambient contamination. That the two designs yield qualitatively consistent results despite this difference in counterfactual construction strengthens confidence that the organizational channel — not merely the existence of a public stance in the world — is the operative mechanism.

Several limitations are important for interpretation. The administrative analysis is restricted to liberal-leaning stances, and while this choice is motivated by measurement considerations discussed in Section 4.1.3, it means the field estimates speak to one directional slice of corporate partisanship — a limitation the survey experiment addresses by randomizing both stance directions. More broadly,

donations are a right-tail measure of political participation. If corporate stances affect lower-cost behaviors (conversation, volunteering, turnout), donation-based estimates may understate the full scope of political spillovers.

A related concern is whether the survey sample is sufficiently representative of the population of interest. To partially mitigate this, I restrict the analytical sample to respondents who are at least 25 years old, in the labor force, and registered to vote. The employees and companies at the center of this study are disproportionately white-collar, and white-collar workers are more likely to be politically active and to donate to campaigns (Bonica, 2016). To the extent that this survey sample is less politically engaged than the LinkedIn workforce, the direction of bias is not clear *ex ante*: we may imagine that politically aware respondents are more attentive to employer signals precisely because they understand their political relevance, in which case the survey results represent a conservative estimate. Or we could imagine that politically aware respondents are more responsive to treatment, consistent with theories of cue-taking among less engaged citizens (Kam, 2005), in which case the survey results would be biased upwards. The political awareness heterogeneity analysis shows that treatment effects on PAC giving are concentrated among high-awareness respondents, with low-awareness respondents showing little average treatment effect (see Appendix B.8). A more politically engaged sample would therefore likely exhibit stronger effects, suggesting the survey estimates are conservative.

The results also point to several natural extensions. One is persistence: whether donation responses persist beyond the event window in observational data and whether repeated exposure leads to habituation or reinforcement. Another is organizational heterogeneity: the strength of the PAC channel likely depends on internal solicitation intensity, workplace norms, and institutional constraints (e.g., whether and how employees are asked to give). A third is general equilibrium: if many firms take stances, employees may re-sort across employers or adjust how they interpret corporate political signals. Understanding these dynamics would help clarify whether corporate partisanship amplifies polarization primarily through short-run activation or through longer-run organizational and labor-market sorting.

7 Conclusion

Corporate political speech has undergone a structural shift. Where firms once engaged politics quietly — through lobbying, regulatory bargaining, and behind-the-scenes PAC giving — they increasingly do so publicly, taking overt and often explicitly partisan positions on salient social issues. That shift has attracted substantial attention to the economic consequences of corporate stances: their effects on consumer demand, investor sentiment, and employee recruitment. This paper asks a different question: do public corporate stances move employee politics?

The answer is yes, and in ways that are both theoretically precise and empirically tractable. Corporate partisan stances increase employee political giving, with effects that are heterogeneous by alignment and channeled through distinct organizational and external pathways. Aligned employees

mobilize — especially toward the firm-linked PAC — while misaligned employees counter-mobilize in their own partisan direction. These patterns hold in observational data on realized giving behavior and replicate in a survey experiment that isolates the organizational channel under controlled exposure. Together, they support a view of the firm as an intermediary political institution: not merely an economic actor responding to a polarized marketplace, but an active participant in structuring where political money flows and who participates in politics.

This reframing carries consequences beyond the immediate findings. If firms shape employee political participation through the stances they take, then the recent wave of corporate conservatism — the rollback of DEI commitments, the revision of reproductive health policies, the distancing from prior racial-justice statements — is not only an economic and reputational story. It is also a political one, with potential downstream effects on employee mobilization, PAC funding, and the partisan composition of political finance. Understanding how corporate partisanship reshapes democratic participation, and whether those effects persist, sort across employers, or compound through organizational infrastructure, is a research agenda whose importance will only grow as the line between corporate and partisan identity continues to blur.

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A Additional Tables and Figures for Observational Analysis

A.1 Analytical Sample of Firm Events

Table A1: Firm events and stance dates

Parent	Date	Event
AT&T	2021-01-11	Insurrection
Airbnb	2021-01-11	Insurrection
Airbnb	2020-06-01	Black Lives Matter
Amazon	2021-01-11	Insurrection
Amazon	2022-05-02	Abortion
Amazon	2020-06-03	Black Lives Matter
American Express	2021-01-11	Insurrection
Apple	2020-06-11	Black Lives Matter
Bank of America	2018-04-10	Gun Rights
Bank of America	2020-06-02	Black Lives Matter
Citi	2018-03-22	Gun Rights
Citi	2022-03-15	Abortion
Citi	2020-09-23	Black Lives Matter
Comcast	2021-01-11	Insurrection
Dell	2021-01-12	Insurrection
Delta Airlines	2018-02-24	Gun Rights
Delta Airlines	2021-03-31	Georgia Voting Laws
Dow, Inc	2021-01-12	Insurrection
JPMorgan	2021-03-31	Georgia Voting Laws
JPMorgan	2022-06-24	Abortion
Microsoft	2022-05-09	Abortion
Microsoft	2020-06-05	Black Lives Matter
Paypal	2020-06-11	Black Lives Matter
Pepsi	2020-10-08	Black Lives Matter
Pepsi	2020-06-16	Black Lives Matter
Starbucks	2022-05-16	Abortion
United	2018-02-24	Gun Rights
Verizon	2021-01-11	Insurrection
Walmart	2021-01-14	Insurrection

Note: This table lists the corporate political stance events used in the analysis. Each row corresponds to a firm–event pairing, where *Parent* is the publicly traded parent company and *Date* is the event date on which the firm's public stance was first issued or reported. *Event* denotes the issue category (Insurrection = responses to January 6, 2021; Georgia Voting Laws = responses to Georgia's Election Integrity Act of 2021; Abortion = abortion and reproductive-rights events; Black Lives Matter = racial-justice statements in 2020; Gun Rights = responses to major gun-policy debates in 2018). Firms may appear multiple times because some companies took stances on multiple issues and/or at multiple dates within an issue.

A.2 Modified Granger causality test

A standard concern in difference-in-differences event studies is that treatment timing may be correlated with unobserved shocks that also move the outcome. To assess whether such confounding dynamics are present in my setting, I implement a modified Granger-style falsification test (Angrist and Pischke, 2008), following the logic used in related DiD applications: if the identifying parallel-trends assumption holds, then "future treatment" (i.e., event-time leads) should not predict current outcomes after conditioning on the fixed effects structure. In this context, this corresponds to augmenting the baseline specification with both lagged and lead values of the treatment interaction and testing whether the lead coefficients are jointly zero.

Concretely, for each outcome Y_{ist} (measured at the employee–stack–week level), I estimate:

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{ist} = \alpha_{is} + \gamma_{cw(s,t)} + \beta_0\big(\mathit{Treated}_{is} \times \mathbb{1}\{t=0\}\big) \\ + \sum_{m=1}^{2} \gamma_m\big(\mathit{Treated}_{is} \times \mathbb{1}\{t=m\}\big) + \sum_{q=2}^{4} \lambda_q\big(\mathit{Treated}_{is} \times \mathbb{1}\{t=-q\}\big) + \varepsilon_{ist}. \end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

where t indexes event-time weeks relative to the stance week ($t = 0$), α_{is} are employee–stack fixed effects, and $\gamma_{cw(s,t)}$ are calendar-week fixed effects. Equation (4) mirrors the modified Granger specification used in the reference design: it includes a small number of post-treatment lags (which may capture persistence) and a small number of pre-treatment leads (which diagnose anticipatory effects or differential pre-trends).

The identifying implication is that the lead coefficients should be zero: statistically significant λ_q would indicate that outcomes begin shifting *before* the stance week in a way that differentially affects treated relative to control employees, violating parallel trends (i.e., "future treatment predicts current outcomes"). Accordingly, I report both the individual lead estimates and an F-test of the joint null

$$H_0 : \lambda_2 = \lambda_3 = \lambda_4 = 0.$$

Table A2 presents the corresponding estimates and lead-test p-values for each donation outcome. Notably, I am unable to reject the null hypothesis across all four outcomes. Moreover, the coefficient of interest on $week = 0$ is positive and significant for total donation amounts, PAC donation amounts, and donation amounts to Democratic organizations.

Table A2: Event-time estimates around stance week

	Total Donation Amt	**Donation to PAC Amt**	**Donation to Dem Amt**	**Donation to Rep Amt**
Lag 2 (week +2)	0.0404 (0.0254)	0.0003 (0.0057)	0.0382 (0.0261)	0.0041 (0.0113)
Lag 1 (week +1)	0.0193 (0.0280)	-0.0113 (0.0076)	0.0449 (0.0300)	-0.0024 (0.0127)
Lag 0 (week 0)	0.1473** (0.0441)	0.0204† (0.0120)	0.1331** (0.0442)	-0.0138 (0.0180)
Lead 2 (week -2)	0.0443 (0.0329)	-0.0031 (0.0065)	0.0583 (0.0346)	0.0184 (0.0242)
Lead 3 (week -3)	0.0432 (0.0371)	-0.0023 (0.0108)	0.0298 (0.0331)	0.0172 (0.0201)
Lead 4 (week -4)	-0.0227 (0.0323)	0.0000432 (0.0078)	-0.0104 (0.0285)	0.0214 (0.0204)
Lead test p-value (H0: Lead -2 = Lead -3 = Lead -4 = 0)	0.3196	0.9674	0.3029	0.6033
Employee-Stack FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Calendar Week FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	24,371,000	23,696,223	24,371,000	24,371,000
R^2	0.14550	0.09232	0.14482	0.11932

Clustered (stack) standard-errors in parentheses
*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, †: 0.1*

A.3 Calendar-week × congressional-district fixed effects

A potential concern in the baseline specification is that contemporaneous shocks may differentially affect political giving across geographic areas—for example, local political campaigns, district-specific news coverage, or mobilization efforts that vary over time and space. If such shocks are correlated with the timing of corporate stances or the composition of treated and control employees across geographies, they could confound the estimated treatment effects. To address this concern, I augment the baseline stacked DiD specification by replacing calendar-week fixed effects with calendar-week × congressional-district fixed effects. This specification flexibly absorbs any time-varying shocks that are common to individuals residing in the same congressional district in a given week, allowing identification to come from treated–control differences net of district-specific week-to-week variation in political giving.

Formally, the alternative specification is

$$Y_{ist} = \alpha_{is} + \delta_{d(i)\times cw(s,t)} + \beta\,(Treated_{is} \times Post_t) + \varepsilon_{ist}, \tag{5}$$

where α_{is} are employee–stack fixed effects and $\delta_{d(i)\times cw(s,t)}$ denotes a full set of fixed effects for congressional district $d(i)$ interacted with calendar week. As in the baseline, standard errors are clustered at the stack level. Because congressional district identifiers are missing for a nontrivial share of observations in the administrative data, including $\delta_{d(i)\times cw(s,t)}$ mechanically reduces the estimation sample size relative to the baseline specification.

Appendix Table A3 reports the corresponding estimates. The results are qualitatively similar to the baseline: exposure to a corporate stance continues to be associated with an increase in overall donation activity, with positive and statistically significant effects on total donation amounts and on donations to Democratic organizations, and a positive effect on PAC donation amounts. Overall, the stability of the findings under calendar-week × congressional-district fixed effects suggests that the main results are not driven by coincident geographic shocks.

Table A3: Main results (including congressional-district × calendar-week fixed effects): intensive and extensive margins

Panel A: Intensive margin (amounts)				
Dependent Variables:	Total donation amount	PAC amount	Amount to Dem orgs	Amount to Rep orgs
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
did	0.1032***	0.0103**	0.0675***	0.0179
	(0.0286)	(0.0043)	(0.0232)	(0.0159)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.295189	0.050055	0.132694	0.084851
Percent change from baseline	34.95	20.55	50.85	21.10
Fixed-effects				
Employee-Stack	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
CD-Calendar Week	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	24,223,000	23,554,276	24,223,000	24,223,000
R^2	0.13967	0.09205	0.12909	0.11832

Panel B: Extensive margin (any/indicator)				
Dependent Variables:	Any donation	Any PAC donation	Any donation to Dem orgs	Any donation to Rep orgs
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
did	0.0005***	0.0001**	0.0002***	8.15×10^{-5}**
	(0.0001)	(4.61×10^{-5})	(8.32×10^{-5})	(3.26×10^{-5})
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.002747	0.000446	0.001437	0.000538
Percent change from baseline	17.35	22.97	17.25	15.14
Fixed-effects				
Employee-Stack	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
CD-Calendar Week	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	24,223,000	23,554,276	24,223,000	24,223,000
R^2	0.27554	0.28670	0.25610	0.27896

Clustered (stack) standard-errors in parentheses
*Signif. Codes: ***: 0.01, **: 0.05, *: 0.1*

A.4 Meta-analysis across stacks

Because the empirical design stacks multiple firm–event windows, Appendix Figure A1 and Table A4 summarize the distribution of stack-specific treatment effects and aggregate them using standard meta-analytic estimators. For each outcome, I first estimate the stack-level $\widehat{\beta}_s$ from equation (1) (or its outcome-specific analogue), and then combine these estimates across stacks using both a fixed-effects (inverse-variance weighted) meta estimator and a random-effects estimator (REML). The fixed-effects estimator provides the precision-weighted average effect under the assumption that all stacks share a common true effect, whereas the random-effects estimator allows true effects to vary across stacks.

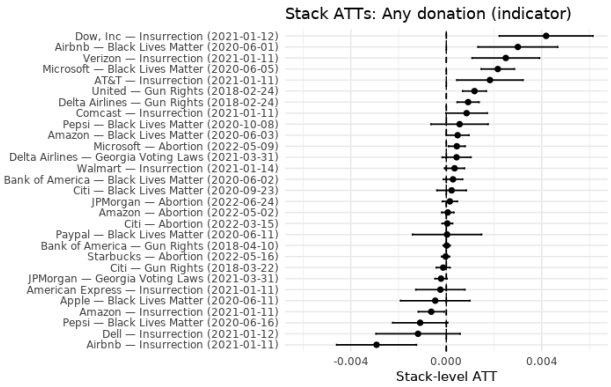
Two results stand out. First, the meta-analytic summaries corroborate the main pooled findings for overall donation activity. For total donation amounts, the fixed-effects meta estimate is positive and precisely estimated (FE = 0.0715, $p < 0.001$), with a similar random-effects estimate (RE = 0.0703, $p = 0.002$). For the extensive margin, the fixed-effects estimate for any donation is also positive (FE = 0.012 pp, $p = 0.001$), with a larger but less precise random-effects estimate (RE = 0.039 pp, $p = 0.057$). Second, for more narrowly defined outcomes—PAC donation amounts, any PAC donation, and donations directed to Democratic or Republican recipients—the meta-analytic averages are smaller and generally not statistically distinguishable from zero, consistent with substantial sampling variability and heterogeneity across events in these finer outcome categories.

The heterogeneity statistics in Table A4 indicate that treatment effects vary meaningfully across stacks for several outcomes. In particular, Cochran's Q rejects homogeneity for total donation amounts and for the indicator outcomes (with $p < 0.001$), and the corresponding I^2 values imply that a sizable share of variation in estimates reflects between-stack heterogeneity rather than sampling error (e.g., $I^2 = 58.7$ for total donation amounts and above 80 for the indicator outcomes). For donations to Republican organizations, by contrast, the Q test is not statistically significant at conventional levels ($p = 0.079$) and I^2 is comparatively low (28.4), suggesting less cross-stack dispersion in that outcome. Overall, these meta-analytic summaries reinforce the conclusion that corporate stances are associated with increases in overall donation activity, while also highlighting that effect magnitudes vary across events and are less stable for narrower recipient categories.

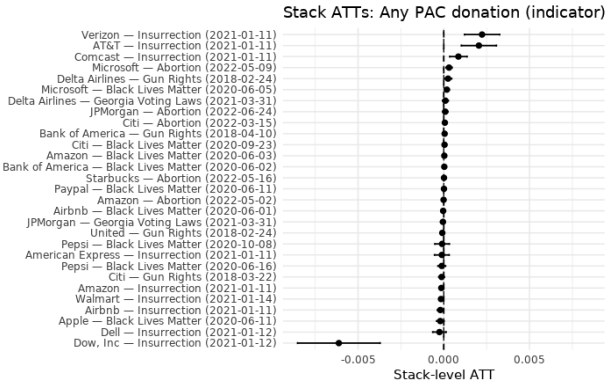
Table A4: Meta-analysis summary across stacks (FE and RE)

Outcome	**k**	**FE (SE)**	**FE p**	**RE (SE)**	**RE p**	**Q**	**Q p**	**I^2**
Total donation amount	29	0.0715*** (0.0132)	< 0.001	0.0703** (0.0226)	0.002	67.74	< 0.001	58.7
Donation amount to Dem orgs	29	0.0088 (0.0064)	0.169	0.0329 (0.0219)	0.133	88.99	< 0.001	68.5
PAC donation amount	29	0.0007 (0.0009)	0.449	0.0033 (0.0030)	0.271	87.69	< 0.001	68.1
Donation amount to Rep orgs	29	0.0025 (0.0042)	0.542	0.0053 (0.0053)	0.323	39.12	0.079	28.4
Any donation (indicator, pp)	29	0.012** (0.004)	0.001	0.039. (0.021)	0.057	161.33	< 0.001	82.6
Any PAC donation (indicator, pp)	29	0.000 (0.001)	0.518	0.006 (0.015)	0.713	157.81	< 0.001	82.3

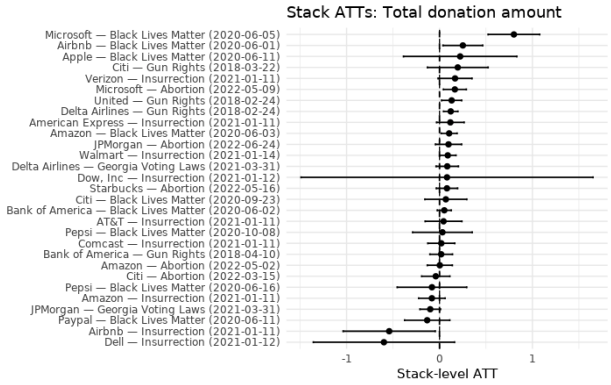
Note: Fixed-effects (FE) meta estimates are inverse-variance weighted. Random-effects (RE) meta estimates use REML. Indicator outcomes are reported in percentage points (pp). Q tests the null of effect homogeneity across stacks; I^2 is the share of total variation attributable to between-stack heterogeneity. Significance codes: *** $p < 0.001$, ** $p < 0.01$, * $p < 0.05$, . $p < 0.1$.



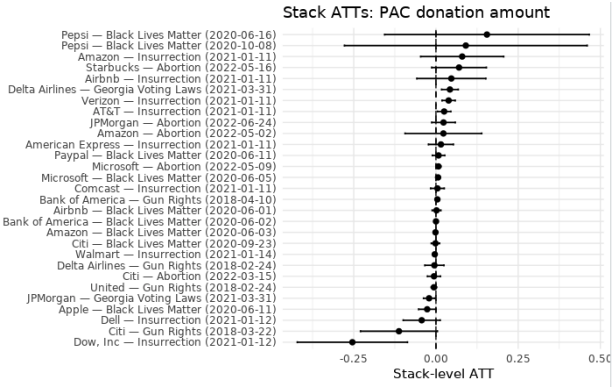
Any (Indicator)



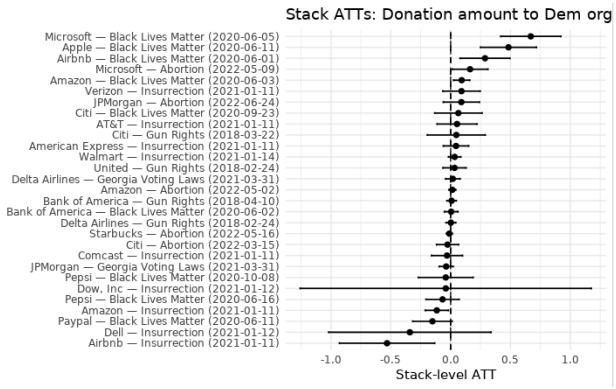
PAC (Indicator)



Total (Amount)



PAC (Amount)



Dem

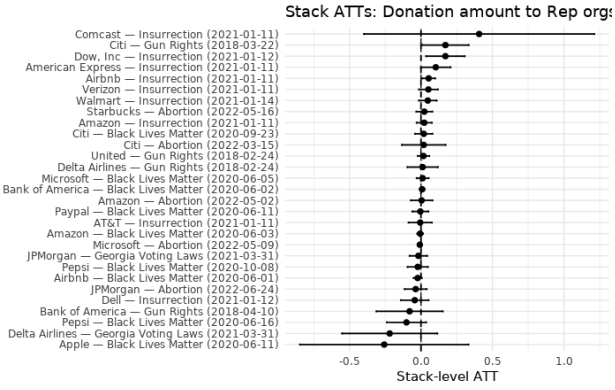


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Figure A1: Meta-analysis figures

A.5 Leave-one-out influence analysis

A related concern in stacked designs is that pooled estimates may be disproportionately influenced by a small number of stacks (firm–event windows). To assess sensitivity to influential events, I conduct a leave-one-out (LOO) influence analysis. Specifically, for each outcome I re-estimate the pooled coefficient from equation (1) repeatedly, each time omitting one stack s from the estimation sample. Let $\widehat{\beta}$ denote the pooled estimate using all stacks and let $\widehat{\beta}^{(-s)}$ denote the estimate obtained after dropping stack s. I summarize influence by the absolute change

$$|\Delta_s| = \left|\widehat{\beta}^{(-s)} - \widehat{\beta}\right|,$$

which captures how much the pooled estimate moves when a given stack is excluded.

Table A5 reports, for each outcome, the three stacks whose omission produces the largest absolute change in the pooled estimate. Across outcomes, the most influential stacks tend to be large, high-salience events (notably Black Lives Matter statements by major technology firms and several January 6–related stances). Even for these stacks, however, the pooled estimates remain qualitatively similar. For example, for total donation amounts the full-sample estimate is 0.120 (SE 0.038); omitting the most influential stack (Microsoft–Black Lives Matter, 2020-06-05) yields an estimate of 0.095 (SE 0.029). For extensive-margin outcomes, the magnitude of influence is mechanically small in levels (e.g., changes on the order of 10^{-5} to 10^{-4} in donation probabilities), and the direction of the pooled effect is unchanged when omitting any single stack.

Overall, the leave-one-out diagnostics indicate that the headline conclusions are not driven by any single firm–event window: while a small number of stacks measurably shift point estimates, no single omission reverses the sign of the estimated effects or generates qualitatively different inferences.

Table A5: Leave-one-out influence analysis (top 3 stacks by absolute change)

Company	Event	Date	Full est. (SE)	LOO est. (SE)	$\lvert\Delta\rvert$
Total donation amount					
Microsoft	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-05	0.1200 (0.0380)	0.0946 (0.0285)	0.0255
Apple	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-11	0.1200 (0.0380)	0.1010 (0.0364)	0.0191
Amazon	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-03	0.1200 (0.0380)	0.1330 (0.0422)	0.0131
Amount to Dem orgs					
Microsoft	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-05	0.0852 (0.0335)	0.0631 (0.0263)	0.0221
Apple	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-11	0.0852 (0.0335)	0.0653 (0.0302)	0.0199
Bank of America	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-02	0.0852 (0.0335)	0.0741 (0.0287)	0.0111
PAC donation amount					
Starbucks	Abortion	2022-05-16	0.0101 (0.00454)	0.00770 (0.00391)	0.00240
Citi	Gun Rights	2018-03-22	0.0101 (0.00454)	0.0123 (0.00409)	0.00225
Amazon	Insurrection	2021-01-11	0.0101 (0.00454)	0.00848 (0.00436)	0.00161
Amount to Rep orgs					
Comcast	Insurrection	2021-01-11	0.0129 (0.0158)	0.00107 (0.0107)	0.0119
Bank of America	Gun Rights	2018-04-10	0.0129 (0.0158)	0.0211 (0.0153)	0.00818
Delta Airlines	Georgia Voting Laws	2021-03-31	0.0129 (0.0158)	0.0173 (0.0157)	0.00437
Any donation (indicator)					
Microsoft	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-05	0.000515 (0.000132)	0.000448 (0.000115)	0.0000666
Apple	Black Lives Matter	2020-06-11	0.000515 (0.000132)	0.000451 (0.000126)	0.0000637
Walmart	Insurrection	2021-01-14	0.000515 (0.000132)	0.000460 (0.000127)	0.0000550
Any PAC donation (indicator)					
Verizon	Insurrection	2021-01-11	0.0000985 (0.0000473)	0.0000744 (0.0000402)	0.0000241
Comcast	Insurrection	2021-01-11	0.0000985 (0.0000473)	0.0000750 (0.0000416)	0.0000235
AT&T	Insurrection	2021-01-11	0.0000985 (0.0000473)	0.0000799 (0.0000427)	0.0000186

Notes: Each panel reports the three stacks whose omission produces the largest absolute change in the pooled estimate. Full est. (SE) is the pooled estimate using all stacks; LOO est. (SE) drops the listed stack. Δ *is LOO−Full.*

B Additional Tables and Figures for Survey Experiment

B.1 Sample Characteristics

Table B1 reports summary statistics for the full survey sample (N = 1,300) and the analytical sample ($N = 842$). The analytical sample restricts respondents to those age 25+, registered to vote, and employed or actively seeking work, aligning the experiment more closely with the population observed in the administrative employment and donation data. As expected, the analytical sample is older than the full sample by construction, while other demographic and political characteristics are broadly similar.

Table B1: Summary Statistics for the Survey Experiment

	Full Sample	Analytical Sample
Male	0.49	0.52
Age	51.69	47.92
White	0.80	0.78
Hispanic	0.10	0.11
Black	0.11	0.12
Asian	0.02	0.02
High School	0.37	0.33
College	0.40	0.44
Graduate School	0.21	0.22
Democrat	0.50	0.50
Republican	0.39	0.38
Political Awareness	0.69	0.68
Political Donor	0.32	0.31
PAC Donor	0.07	0.08
N	1300	842

To contextualize baseline issue attitudes, Table B2 benchmarks the experimental sample against contemporaneous Pew estimates on the same broad issues. Across abortion, DEI, and transgender equality, the experimental sample is more supportive of liberal positions than the Pew benchmark, though the gaps are modest for abortion and transgender equality and larger for DEI.

Figure B1 visualizes the distribution of baseline issue attitudes in the analytical sample, splitting respondents into pro, neutral, and anti categories for each issue.

Table B2: Respondents are liberal, but roughly as liberal as the nationally representative respondents in Pew.

	Experimental Sample	Pew Sample
Abortion		
Pro	73%	63%
Anti	20%	36%
DEI		
Pro	68%	52%
Anti	24%	21%
Transgender Equality		
Pro	61%	56%
Anti	28%	26%

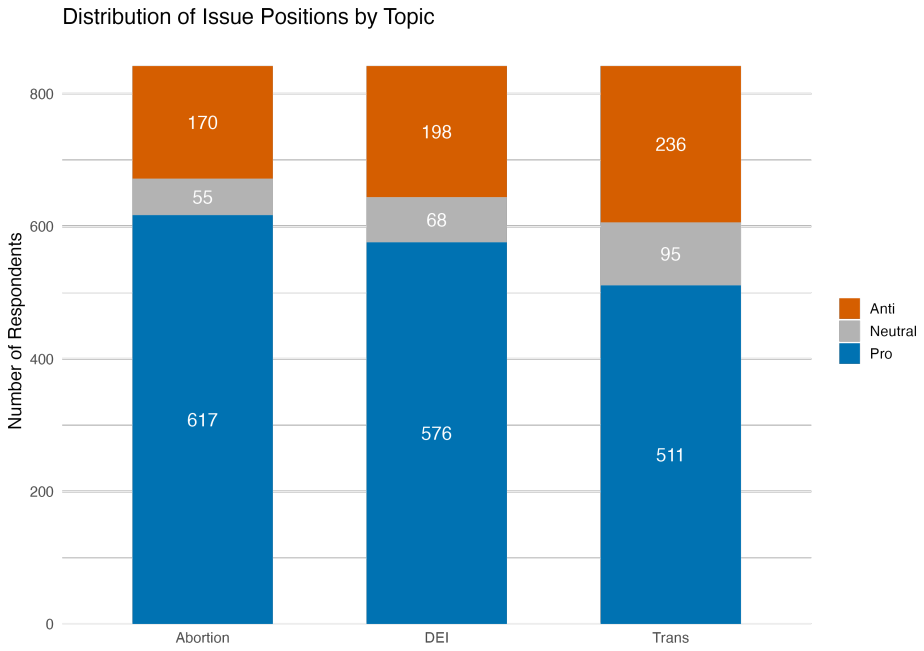


Figure B1: Distribution of baseline issue attitudes by policy domain

B.2 Sample Weighting

I use sample weights provided by Verasight, the survey provider. Sample weights are used to ensure that the survey data accurately represents the broader population. Verasight uses raking to perform iterative proportion fitting. This adjusts survey weights such that the sample aligns with known population margins (provided by ANES sample statistics). All weights are capped at a maximum value of 5.0 to reduce variance in weights. Verasight weights on the following demographics:

- Gender
- Age
- Education
- Race / Ethnicity
- Region
- Metropolitan Status
- Income
- Party ID
- 2024 Presidential Vote Choice

Weighted sample averages can be found in Table B3.

Table B3: Weighted Summary Statistics for the Survey Experiment

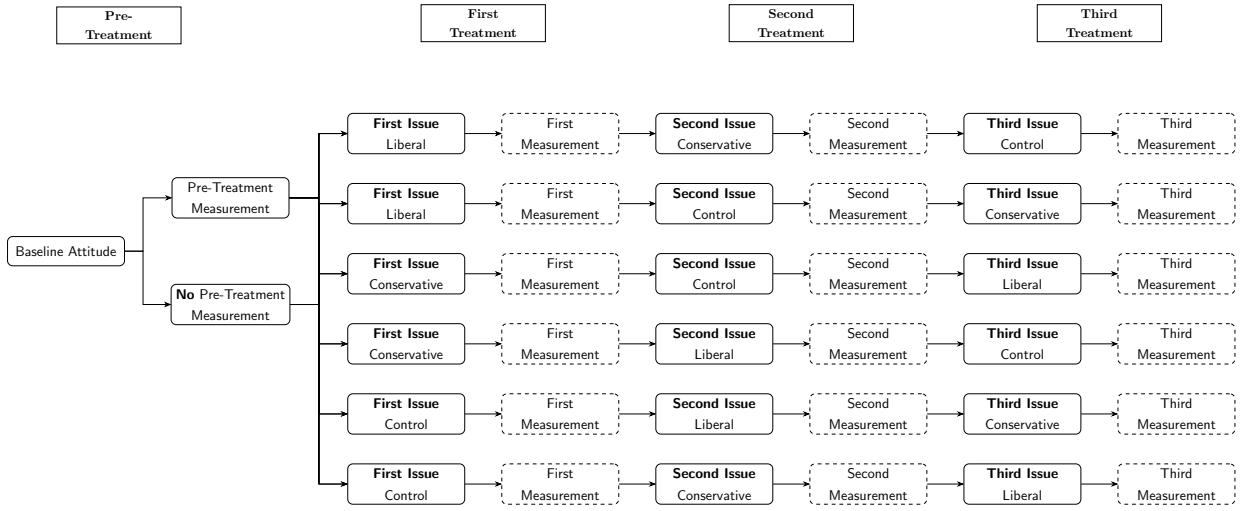
	Full Sample	Analytical Sample	Main Sample
Male	0.48	0.52	0.49
Age	0.50	46.8	47.2
White	0.77	0.75	0.75
Hispanic	0.11	0.13	0.14
Black	0.12	0.13	0.13
Asian	0.03	0.03	0.03
High School	0.47	0.42	0.40
College	0.35	0.38	0.41
Graduate School	0.16	0.18	0.17
Democrat	0.44	0.44	0.47
Republican	0.44	0.43	0.43
N	1300	842	425

B.3 Randomization and experimental protocol

This appendix details the experimental randomization and provides a schematic of the protocol. Respondents are exposed to three issue modules (abortion, DEI hiring, transgender equality). Within each module, they read a vignette describing a hypothetical employer's public response. For each issue, respondents are randomly assigned to one of three stance conditions: a liberal stance (supportive), a conservative stance (oppositional), or a neutral control in which the employer declines to take a stance. Issue order is randomized across respondents.

The primary analysis uses the repeated-measures arm, in which respondents provide pre-treatment measures of the key behavioral outcomes prior to vignette exposure and then report the same outcomes post-treatment. A second arm omits pre-treatment measures and is used to implement a modified Solomon design that diagnoses instrument reactivity (Malhotra, Monin, & Tomz, 2019). Figure B2 summarizes the resulting protocol and treatment sequencing.

Figure B2: Respondents are randomized to see one liberal, one conservative, and one control vignette across three issues (abortion, transgender rights, and DEI hiring), with an additional randomization determining whether pre-treatment outcomes are measured.



B.4 Outcome Means

Table B4 reports raw (unadjusted) pre–post mean allocations, pooled across issues, by treatment arm (Conservative, Liberal, Control) and respondents' baseline orientation (Conservative, Liberal, Neutral). These descriptive means are not causal estimates—they do not condition on issue fixed effects or account for sampling variation—but they provide a transparent summary of the magnitudes and the direction of changes that underlie the regression results in the main text.

Several patterns stand out. First, baseline giving is sharply polarized by respondent type: liberal respondents allocate substantially more to liberal organizations than conservative or neutral respondents across all arms in the pre-treatment period, while conservative respondents allocate substantially more to conservative organizations than liberal or neutral respondents. This stark separation is useful for interpretation because it confirms that the "respondent type" grouping based on pre-treatment feelings corresponds to meaningful differences in baseline giving.

Second, the pre–post changes in partisan giving generally move in a direction consistent with directional responsiveness. For example, PAC giving increases for conservatives in the Conservative treatment (from 4.21 to 6.69), while PAC giving increases for liberals in the Liberal treatment (from 5.08 to 12.28). Meanwhile, changes in the control arm tend to be smaller and less systematically aligned with the stance direction, which is consistent with the control condition capturing background variation and generic pre–post dynamics.

Third, the most pronounced raw movements occur for PAC giving rather than for partisan giving to Democratic or Republican organizations. This is visible in the large increase in liberal respondents' PAC allocations in the Liberal treatment and in the increase for conservative respondents' PAC allocations in the Conservative treatment. In contrast, changes in giving to Democratic and Republican organizations are comparatively modest and sometimes move in the same direction across arms, suggesting that much of the treatment-relevant action in this design may operate through the PAC channel rather than through reallocations between partisan organizations.

Finally, "Kept Money" provides a useful complement: when donation amounts rise in a given cell, retained funds tend to fall (and vice versa), consistent with the budget constraint built into the allocation task. Notably, neutral respondents retain the most in every arm and period, which matches the interpretation that neutral respondents are systematically less willing to allocate funds away from themselves in this task.

Table B4: Donation Behavior by Treatment and Respondent Alignment

	Conservative Treatment		**Liberal Treatment**		**Control Treatment**	
	Pre-Treatment	Post-Treatment	Pre-Treatment	Post-Treatment	Pre-Treatment	Post-Treatment
Liberal Donations						
Conservative Respondent	4.04	4.66	6.70	7.05	3.99	4.43
Liberal Respondent	45.82	48.43	48.09	43.70	45.26	45.92
Neutral Respondent	11.54	12.91	13.62	10.12	16.76	13.97
Conservative Donations						
Conservative Respondent	41.06	40.09	41.34	40.15	38.56	36.67
Liberal Respondent	12.74	10.92	11.64	10.29	12.67	11.09
Neutral Respondent	13.00	12.49	7.67	6.31	5.29	7.65
PAC Donations						
Conservative Respondent	4.21	6.69	4.52	3.17	7.46	5.43
Liberal Respondent	5.27	5.13	5.08	12.28	6.79	5.33
Neutral Respondent	10.29	6.91	10.24	5.36	3.97	2.35
Kept Money						
Conservative Respondent	50.68	48.55	47.44	49.63	49.99	53.47
Liberal Respondent	36.18	35.52	35.20	33.72	35.29	37.66
Neutral Respondent	65.17	67.69	68.48	78.21	73.97	76.03

Note: Each cell displays the mean outcome before and after treatment. Values represent donation or retention amounts (not percentages), pooled across issues.

B.5 Heterogeneity by Issue

This appendix section examines whether the core treatment effects documented in the main text vary across the three issue domains included in the experiment: abortion, DEI, and trans rights. I estimate a pooled specification that allows the key post-treatment effects to differ by issue via interactions with issue indicators. I then recover and plot the implied issue-specific effects with 95% confidence intervals.

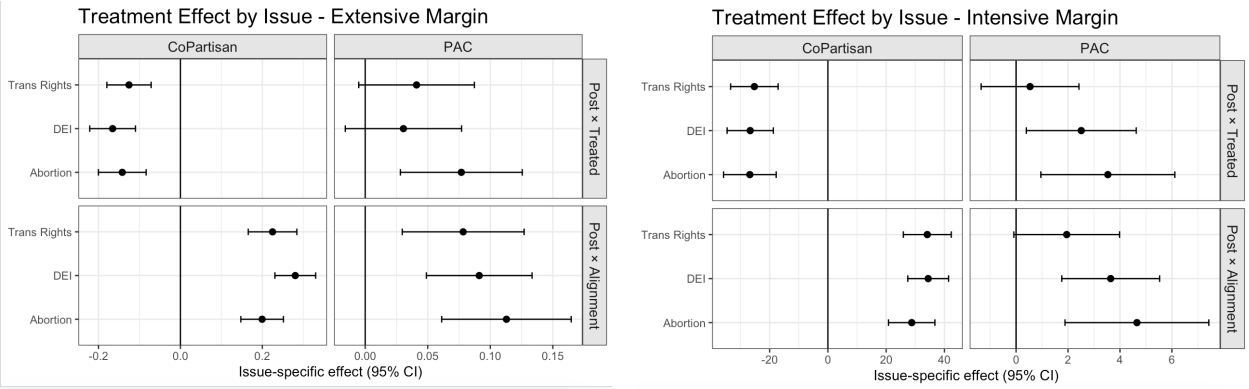
Concretely, I stack the pre- and post-treatment outcome measures and estimate, separately for each outcome family and margin (intensive and extensive), a respondent fixed-effects model of the form:

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{ijt} &= \alpha_i + \gamma_j + \beta_1 \,\text{Post}_t + \beta_{2j} \left(\text{Post}_t \times \text{Treated}_{ij}\right) \\ &\quad + \beta_{3j} \left(\text{Post}_t \times \text{Alignment}_{ij}\right) + \varepsilon_{ijt}. \end{aligned} \tag{6}$$

where i indexes respondents, j indexes issues, and $t \in \{0, 1\}$ indexes the pre/post measurement. α_i are respondent fixed effects, γ_j are issue fixed effects, and standard errors are clustered by respondent. The coefficients β_{2j} and β_{3j} are allowed to vary by issue j via interactions with issue indicators in a single pooled regression. The analysis uses survey weights and follows the main text by restricting to non-neutral respondents (Feeling $\neq 0$) when estimating specifications that include the alignment term. Outcomes are (i) co-partisan donations (excluding PAC; defined as donations to the respondent's co-partisan non-PAC organizations) and (ii) PAC donations, each measured on intensive (amount) and extensive (any/indicator) margins. Figures B3b and B3a plot the recovered issue-specific effects for Post $\times$ Treated and Post $\times$ Alignment.

Across all three issues, the issue-specific Post $\times$ Alignment coefficients are positive for both co-partisan donations and PAC giving on both the intensive and extensive margins. This mirrors the main findings: employees who are more aligned with the employer's stance exhibit larger post-treatment increases in politically congruent behavior. Importantly, the alignment gradients are not driven by a single issue domain; instead, they appear consistently across abortion, DEI, and trans rights, with broadly overlapping confidence intervals.

The issue-specific Post $\times$ Treated coefficients are more mixed across outcomes, which is also consistent with the paper's core interpretation that the average (net) treated effect can mask heterogeneity by alignment. In particular, for co-partisan donations, the Post $\times$ Treated effect is negative across issues, while the Post $\times$ Alignment effect is strongly positive. This combination implies that treatment increases co-partisan giving for sufficiently aligned respondents, but can reduce it for sufficiently misaligned respondents. By contrast, for PAC giving, both Post $\times$ Treated and Post $\times$ Alignment are generally positive across issues, indicating that the stance treatment shifts PAC giving upward on average while also increasing the gradient with alignment. Overall, the within-issue evidence supports the main results: the alignment mechanism operates similarly across abortion, DEI, and trans rights.



(a) Extensive margin

(b) Intensive margin

Figure B3: Heterogeneity by issue

B.6 Vignette Order Effects

To assess whether vignette position (first/second/third) affects responses, we estimate an "order-robust" specification that allows for (i) main effects of order, (ii) order-by-post interactions (capturing differential pre–post shifts by vignette position), and (iii) interactions between order and the key *post* × *treated* and *post* × *alignment* terms. We focus on the non-neutral sample (Feeling $\neq 0$), consistent with the alignment-based specifications in the main text. Table B5 reports the full regression results for Any and PAC outcomes on intensive and extensive margins, and Table B6 reports joint-test p-values for the order-related coefficient blocks. Overall, we fail to reject the null hypothesis that vignette order has no effect on responses (and does not differentially moderate the treatment or alignment effects).

Table B5: Order robustness: intensive and extensive margins

	Any		PAC	
	(1) Ext.	**(2) Int.**	**(3) Ext.**	**(4) Int.**
Variables				
Post	-0.0154	-2.486	-0.0257	-0.4017
	(0.0215)	(1.997)	(0.0214)	(0.9776)
Order: 2nd	-0.0098	-2.123	-0.0053	-0.9896
	(0.0166)	(1.527)	(0.0139)	(0.5878)
Order: 3rd	0.0060	-0.0459	-0.0059	-0.8347
	(0.0164)	(1.555)	(0.0154)	(0.6408)
Post × Order: 2nd	-0.0347	-1.263	0.0112	1.353
	(0.0337)	(3.018)	(0.0325)	(1.533)
Post × Order: 3rd	-0.0181	1.229	-0.0651	-1.604
	(0.0331)	(2.904)	(0.0373)	(1.635)
Post × Treated	0.0115	2.737	0.0115	1.018
	(0.0273)	(2.444)	(0.0289)	(1.393)
Post × Alignment	0.0056	0.5330	0.1104***	2.716*
	(0.0205)	(1.851)	(0.0251)	(1.157)
Post × Treated × Order: 2nd	0.0693	4.691	0.0278	1.390
	(0.0446)	(3.849)	(0.0454)	(2.280)
Post × Treated × Order: 3rd	-0.0033	-3.267	0.1182*	3.624
	(0.0397)	(3.378)	(0.0473)	(2.126)
Post × Alignment × Order: 2nd	-0.0066	0.3130	-0.0053	1.891
	(0.0289)	(2.645)	(0.0344)	(1.685)
Post × Alignment × Order: 3rd	0.0296	1.822	-0.0028	2.080
	(0.0314)	(2.851)	(0.0350)	(1.717)
Fixed-effects				
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	2,328	2,328	2,328	2,328
R^2	0.771	0.799	0.713	0.538

Notes: Non-neutral sample (Feeling $\neq 0$). Standard errors clustered by respondent in parentheses. Significance codes: $^{***}p < 0.001$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$.

Table B6: Order robustness: joint tests of order-related coefficient blocks

	Any	**PAC**
Panel A: Intensive margin		
Order main effects (Order: 2nd = Order: 3rd = 0)	0.280	0.237
Post × Order (Post × Order: 2nd = Post × Order: 3rd = 0)	0.721	0.235
Post × Treated × Order (joint)	0.223	0.542
Post × Alignment × Order (joint)	0.771	0.389
Panel B: Extensive margin		
Order main effects (Order: 2nd = Order: 3rd = 0)	0.659	0.910
Post × Order (Post × Order: 2nd = Post × Order: 3rd = 0)	0.584	0.123
Post × Treated × Order (joint)	0.120	0.539
Post × Alignment × Order (joint)	0.379	0.988

Notes: Entries are p-values from joint Wald χ^2 tests of the indicated coefficient sets. The models are estimated on the non-neutral sample (Feeling $\neq 0$), with respondent and issue fixed effects.

B.7 Modified Solomon Design: Instrument Reactivity

To assess whether the pre-treatment measurement itself alters post-treatment responses (instrument reactivity), I implement a modified Solomon-type design embedded within the repeated-measures experiment. Respondents are randomly assigned either to a *pre/post* condition (in which baseline donation allocations are elicited prior to exposure to the employer-stance vignette) or a *post-only* condition (in which outcomes are elicited only after exposure).[20]

I estimate post-treatment outcomes as a function of stance-arm indicators, stance-by-alignedness interactions (so that treatment effects may vary with alignment), and a set of pretest indicators and interactions that capture instrument reactivity. Concretely, the coefficient on *Had pretest* measures average differences between pre/post and post-only respondents in the control arm, while the interactions *Had pretest* × *Liberal stance*, *Had pretest* × *Conservative stance*, and the corresponding alignedness interactions measure whether treatment effects differ depending on whether a respondent received the baseline instrument.

Table B7 reports results for Any and PAC outcomes on both intensive and extensive margins. Across all specifications, the pretest-related coefficients are statistically indistinguishable from zero, indicating little evidence that eliciting baseline outcomes systematically alters post-treatment responses. This pattern suggests that the primary treatment effects documented in the main text are unlikely to be driven by measurement-induced reactivity, consistent with the approach in Malhotra, Monin, and Tomz (2019).

[20]The standard Solomon design features four groups; here the design is adapted to accommodate the three stance arms (Liberal, Conservative, Control) and the survey's alignment structure.

Table B7: Modified Solomon design: post-treatment outcomes with pretest interactions

	Any		PAC	
	(1) Intensive	(2) Extensive	(3) Intensive	(4) Extensive
Variables				
Liberal stance	-3.485	-0.0306	4.320**	0.0653**
	(2.387)	(0.0267)	(1.414)	(0.0231)
Conservative stance	0.6776	0.0004	1.121	-0.0073
	(2.379)	(0.0257)	(1.476)	(0.0229)
Had pretest	3.819	0.0497	-2.476	-0.0394
	(3.468)	(0.0370)	(1.405)	(0.0318)
Liberal stance × alignedness	12.77***	0.1313***	5.647***	0.1518***
	(2.719)	(0.0302)	(1.401)	(0.0251)
Conservative stance × alignedness	-6.659*	-0.0603*	3.277*	0.0276
	(2.840)	(0.0302)	(1.483)	(0.0260)
Had pretest × Liberal stance	3.257	0.0228	-2.302	-0.0124
	(3.185)	(0.0355)	(1.679)	(0.0311)
Had pretest × Conservative stance	-0.7697	0.0077	-0.4652	0.0194
	(3.340)	(0.0363)	(1.735)	(0.0327)
Had pretest × Liberal stance × Alignment	-6.206	-0.0645	-1.559	-0.0662
	(3.816)	(0.0416)	(1.609)	(0.0347)
Had pretest × Conservative stance × Alignment	1.281	0.0173	-2.459	-0.0005
	(3.916)	(0.0421)	(1.743)	(0.0374)
Fixed-effects				
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	2,308	2,308	2,308	2,308
R^2	0.0226	0.0208	0.0465	0.0427

Notes: Outcomes are post-treatment only. Standard errors clustered by respondent in parentheses.
Significance codes: $^{***}p < 0.001$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$.

B.8 Heterogeneity by Political Awareness

In addition to estimating average treatment effects, I explore heterogeneity by political awareness. Following the pre-analysis plan, I estimate the core PAC giving specifications (H1 and H2) separately for respondents with high and low political awareness, defined by a median split of a continuous awareness index constructed from five pre-treatment knowledge items drawn from the ANES: (1) placing the Democratic and Republican parties on a liberal-conservative scale, (2) identifying on which category the U.S. government currently spends the least, (3) identifying which party currently holds the most seats in the U.S. House of Representatives, (4) identifying which party currently holds the most seats in the U.S. Senate, and (5) identifying the term length of a U.S. Senator. Each item is coded as correct or incorrect, and I take the average across all six to form a continuous index, which I then dichotomize at the median to define high and low awareness subgroups.

My pre-registered hypothesis was that lower-awareness respondents would exhibit stronger treatment effects, consistent with theories of cue-taking among less engaged citizens (Kam, 2005). The results in Table B8 do not support this prediction. Instead, treatment effects on PAC giving are concentrated almost entirely among high-awareness respondents. On the extensive margin, the estimated *Post* $\times$ *Treated* effect for high-awareness respondents is 0.094 ($p < 0.001$), compared to a near-zero and statistically indistinguishable from zero effect of 0.009 among low-awareness respondents. The alignment gradient (*Post* $\times$ *Alignment*) similarly strengthens with awareness, rising from 0.075 among low-awareness respondents to 0.155 among high-awareness respondents.

This pattern is consistent with an alternative interpretation in which political awareness is a prerequisite for recognizing and responding to employer partisan cues: employees must first identify the stance as a politically meaningful signal before it can activate giving behavior. Low-awareness respondents may encounter the same information but fail to connect it to political action. As discussed in Section 6, this finding also speaks to the external validity of the survey experiment more broadly: to the extent the survey sample is less politically engaged than the white-collar workforce in the administrative analysis, the survey estimates are likely conservative.

Table B8: PAC giving by political awareness subgroup

	Low Awareness		**High Awareness**	
Panel A: Intensive margin (PAC amount)				
	Low H1	Low H2	High H1	High H2
Variables				
Post	-1.245 (1.252)	-1.186 (1.321)	0.216 (0.698)	0.374 (0.750)
Post × Treated	0.678 (1.056)	1.066 (1.206)	3.595*** (0.969)	4.159*** (1.081)
Post × Alignment		3.031** (1.114)		5.919*** (0.968)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	9.791	10.070	4.095	4.433
Fixed-effects				
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	990	910	1,260	1,148
R^2	0.527	0.541	0.539	0.578
Panel B: Extensive margin (any PAC donation)				
	Low H1	Low H2	High H1	High H2
Variables				
Post	-0.047* (0.023)	-0.053* (0.025)	-0.026 (0.017)	-0.025 (0.018)
Post × Treated	0.009 (0.021)	0.012 (0.024)	0.094*** (0.017)	0.112*** (0.021)
Post × Alignment		0.075*** (0.020)		0.155*** (0.020)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.327	0.342	0.171	0.186
Fixed-effects				
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	990	910	1,260	1,148
R^2	0.739	0.746	0.693	0.736

Notes: Sample split at median pol_aware. Low = below median; High = at or above median. Respondent and issue fixed effects in all specifications. Standard errors clustered by respondent. Signif. codes: $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

B.9 Anonymity Moderation

The survey randomized respondents into two conditions: half were told that any donations would be made on their behalf, while half were told donations would be made anonymously. The PAP pre-registers this as an additional test, predicting that treatment effects should be weaker for respondents in the anonymous condition — the reasoning being that if responses are partly driven by social desirability or signaling concerns, removing observability should attenuate them. Table B9 reports the main specification (Equation 2) estimated separately within each condition.

The results offer partial support for the PAP prediction, with an important qualification. On the intensive margin, the alignment gradient is indeed substantially attenuated in the anonymous condition: Post $\times$ Aligned Intensity on any giving drops from 3.422 ($p < 0.001$) in the non-anonymous condition to 0.955 ($p > 0.1$) in the anonymous condition, and the misaligned mobilization effect on any giving similarly disappears (2.387, $p < 0.01$ vs. 0.236, $p > 0.1$). This pattern is consistent with the PAP prediction and suggests that at least some of the intensive margin reallocation reflects social presentation rather than underlying preferences.

The extensive margin tells a different story, however. The aligned PAC gradient remains positive and significant in both conditions (non-anonymous: $\hat{\beta} = 0.072$, $p < 0.001$; anonymous: $\hat{\beta} = 0.042$, $p < 0.001$), and the misaligned PAC withholding effect is, if anything, stronger in the anonymous condition (non-anonymous: $\hat{\beta} = 0.002$, $p > 0.1$; anonymous: $\hat{\beta} = -0.024$, $p < 0.01$). The co-partisan backlash among misaligned respondents also persists in the anonymous condition on the intensive margin ($\hat{\beta} = 1.887$, $p < 0.05$). These results suggest that the core mechanisms identified in the main text — PAC approval among aligned employees and PAC withholding among misaligned employees — reflect genuine behavioral preferences rather than social desirability responses. The attenuation on the intensive margin is more plausibly attributable to the constrained budget design, where the non-anonymous condition may amplify expressive reallocation within the dollar without changing whether respondents donate at all. Taken together, the anonymity results do not undermine the main findings; the extensive margin results, which are the more interpretable signal given the budget constraint, are robust across both conditions.

Table B9: Anonymity moderation: treatment effects by anonymity condition

Panel A: Intensive margin (amounts)						
	Non-Anonymous			**Anonymous**		
Dependent Variables:	Any	PAC	Co-partisan	Any	PAC	Co-partisan
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Variables						
Post	-5.129^{**}	-1.650^{*}	-2.036	-1.822	-0.138	-2.205
	(1.821)	(0.704)	(1.865)	(1.601)	(1.059)	(1.863)
Post × Aligned Intensity	3.422^{***}	3.330^{***}	0.101	0.955	1.538^{*}	0.009
	(0.765)	(0.608)	(0.979)	(0.702)	(0.629)	(0.983)
Post × Misaligned Intensity	2.387^{**}	0.439	$1.575^{\dagger}$	0.236	-0.763^{*}	1.887^{*}
	(0.791)	(0.396)	(0.870)	(0.734)	(0.336)	(0.956)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	51.835	6.893	39.938	57.648	7.661	47.755
Fixed-effects						
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics						
Observations	1,338	1,338	1,212	1,212	1,212	1,116
R^2	0.777	0.548	0.725	0.822	0.522	0.693

Panel B: Extensive margin (any/indicator)						
	Non-Anonymous			**Anonymous**		
Dependent Variables:	Any	PAC	Co-partisan	Any	PAC	Co-partisan
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Variables						
Post	-0.056^{*}	-0.068^{***}	$-0.044^{\dagger}$	$-0.030^{\dagger}$	-0.014	-0.050^{*}
	(0.022)	(0.020)	(0.023)	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.022)
Post × Aligned Intensity	0.028^{***}	0.072^{***}	$0.018^{\dagger}$	0.019^{*}	0.042^{***}	0.025^{*}
	(0.008)	(0.012)	(0.010)	(0.008)	(0.012)	(0.011)
Post × Misaligned Intensity	0.020^{*}	0.002	0.010	0.008	-0.024^{**}	$0.018^{\dagger}$
	(0.009)	(0.008)	(0.010)	(0.008)	(0.008)	(0.011)
Baseline mean (pre, control)	0.620	0.233	0.621	0.661	0.254	0.670
Fixed-effects						
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics						
Observations	1,338	1,338	1,212	1,212	1,212	1,116
R^2	0.740	0.702	0.729	0.785	0.718	0.677

Notes: Respondent and issue fixed effects included in all specifications.
Standard errors clustered by respondent in parentheses.
Non-Anonymous: respondents told donations will be made on their behalf.
Anonymous: respondents told donations will be made anonymously.
PAP prediction: treatment effects should be weaker in the anonymous condition.
All p-values two-tailed. Signif. codes: $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

B.10 PAP H2: Alignment Moderation (Post-Treatment Only)

The pre-analysis plan (PAP) specifies H2 as a within-respondent, within-issue test of whether ideological alignment moderates the association between a corporate political stance and political behavior. Specifically, the PAP hypothesizes that "the association between an employer's corporate stance and political behavior differs across issues according to that individual's level of ideological congruence." The PAP-compliant specification uses post-treatment observations only and exploits within-respondent, across-issue variation in both stance direction and issue-specific feelings to identify the alignment gradient, after absorbing respondent and issue fixed effects.

The main text reports a pre/post within-respondent design (Equation 3, Table 5) that is strictly more efficient than the PAP specification, since it additionally differences out respondent-issue baseline levels of giving. Table B10 reports the PAP-compliant specification for transparency: all respondents in the analytical sample are included, outcomes are measured at post-treatment only, and the right-hand side contains `AlignedIntensity` and `MisalignedIntensity` directly rather than interacted with a post-treatment indicator.

The results strongly confirm PAP H2. On both margins and across all three outcome channels, the alignment gradient operates in the predicted direction and is precisely estimated. Aligned respondents give significantly more in total ($\hat{\beta} = 2.051$, $p < 0.001$ intensive; $\hat{\beta} = 0.022$, $p < 0.001$ extensive) and direct that giving disproportionately toward the employer's PAC ($\hat{\beta} = 3.002$, $p < 0.001$ intensive; $\hat{\beta} = 0.067$, $p < 0.001$ extensive), consistent with an organizational approval channel. Misaligned respondents withhold from the PAC ($\hat{\beta} = -0.648$, $p < 0.01$ intensive; $\hat{\beta} = -0.019$, $p < 0.001$ extensive) while increasing donations to their own partisan side ($\hat{\beta} = 1.968$, $p < 0.001$ intensive; $\hat{\beta} = 0.012$, $p < 0.05$ extensive), consistent with a backlash channel. The coefficients are closely consistent in magnitude and direction with the pre/post estimates in Table 5, confirming that the choice of estimator does not materially affect the substantive conclusions.

Table B10: PAP-preregistered H2 specification: alignment moderation (post-treatment only, within-respondent)

Panel A: Intensive margin (amounts)			
Dependent Variables:	Any Donation	PAC Donation	Co-partisan non-PAC
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Variables			
Aligned Intensity	2.140^{***}	2.850^{***}	-0.377
	(0.383)	(0.334)	(0.516)
Misaligned Intensity	1.067^{**}	-0.727^{**}	1.968^{***}
	(0.404)	(0.223)	(0.482)
Baseline mean (control)	54.754	6.302	41.160
Fixed-effects			
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics			
Observations	$2,526$	$2,526$	$2,271$
R^2	0.856	0.624	0.752

Panel B: Extensive margin (any/indicator)			
Dependent Variables:	Any Donation	PAC Donation	Co-partisan non-PAC
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Variables			
Aligned Intensity	0.023^{***}	0.063^{***}	0.021^{***}
	(0.004)	(0.006)	(0.006)
Misaligned Intensity	$0.009^{\dagger}$	-0.020^{***}	0.012^{*}
	(0.005)	(0.004)	(0.005)
Baseline mean (control)	0.637	0.210	0.575
Fixed-effects			
Respondent FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics			
Observations	$2,526$	$2,526$	$2,271$
R^2	0.828	0.737	0.769

Notes: Post-treatment observations only. All respondents in analytical sample included. Respondent and issue fixed effects included in all specifications.
Standard errors clustered by respondent in parentheses.
Signif. codes: $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{***}p < 0.001$.

B.11 PAP H3: Between-Respondent Design

The pre-analysis plan (PAP) specifies H3 as a between-respondent, within-issue test of whether ideological congruence moderates the relationship between a corporate political stance and employee political behavior. Specifically, the PAP hypothesizes that "across different individuals facing the same issue, the relationship between an employer's corporate stance and political behavior varies with each respondent's level of ideological congruence." The PAP-compliant specification uses post-treatment observations only, exploits between-respondent variation in alignment and stance direction within issues, and includes issue fixed effects. Unlike the within-respondent specifications in the main text, this design does not absorb respondent fixed effects and does not rely on pre/post changes — it is a purely cross-sectional test of whether alignment moderates post-treatment giving levels across respondents. To parallel the heterogeneity specifications in the main survey analysis, we estimate regressions of the form:

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{ij} &= \beta_0 + \beta_1 \,\text{Liberal stance}_{ij} + \beta_2 \,\text{Conservative stance}_{ij} \\ &\quad + \beta_3 \Big(\text{Liberal stance}_{ij} \times \text{Alignment}_{ij}\Big) + \beta_4 \Big(\text{Conservative stance}_{ij} \times \text{Alignment}_{ij}\Big) \\ &\quad + \gamma_j + \varepsilon_{ij}. \end{aligned}$$

where Y_{ij} is the post outcome for respondent i on issue j, γ_j denotes issue fixed effects, and standard errors are clustered by respondent. Alignment is coded so that the interaction terms can be interpreted as: greater alignment implies a larger treatment effect within each stance arm. Table B11 reports results for both the intensive margin (amounts) and the extensive margin (any/indicator) across four outcomes: any giving, PAC giving, giving to Democratic organizations, and giving to Republican organizations.

Table B11 reports results for both the intensive and extensive margins across four behavioral outcomes: any giving, PAC giving, giving to Democratic organizations, and giving to Republican organizations. The results strongly confirm PAP H3. Across both margins, alignment interactions move in the predicted direction: liberal-aligned respondents shift toward Democratic organizations under liberal stances (extensive margin: $\hat{\beta} = 0.280$, $p < 0.001$) and away from Republican organizations, while conservative-aligned respondents shift toward Republican organizations under conservative stances ($\hat{\beta} = 0.163$, $p < 0.001$) and away from Democratic ones. PAC giving is increasing in alignment under both liberal stances ($\hat{\beta} = 0.138$, $p < 0.001$) and conservative stances ($\hat{\beta} = 0.032$), consistent with the organizational approval channel documented in the main text. These patterns are broadly consistent with the within-respondent findings in Table 5, reinforcing the conclusion that ideological alignment is the central dimension along which corporate partisan stances reshape employee political behavior.

Table B11: Between-respondent post-only heterogeneity by treatment arm and alignment

Panel A: Intensive margin (amounts)				
Dependent Variables:	Any	PAC	Dem orgs	Rep orgs
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
Liberal stance	-1.995	3.136***	-10.592***	5.461***
	(1.630)	(0.847)	(1.319)	(1.354)
Conservative stance	-0.210	0.890	-6.693***	5.592***
	(1.654)	(0.854)	(1.420)	(1.445)
Liberal stance × Alignment	11.516***	5.725***	20.155***	-14.363***
	(2.198)	(0.904)	(1.153)	(1.813)
Conservative stance × Alignment	-8.255***	2.268*	-23.686***	13.163***
	(2.193)	(0.960)	(1.353)	(1.757)
Baseline mean (Control)	56.799	6.321	34.788	15.690
Fixed-effects				
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	2,308	2,308	2,308	2,308
R^2	0.024	0.038	0.136	0.087

Panel B: Extensive margin (any/indicator)				
Dependent Variables:	Any	Any PAC	Any Dem	Any Rep
Model:	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Variables				
Liberal stance	-0.021	0.059***	-0.090***	0.046**
	(0.018)	(0.016)	(0.017)	(0.017)
Conservative stance	0.001	0.003	-0.088***	0.070***
	(0.018)	(0.016)	(0.018)	(0.019)
Liberal stance × Alignment	0.117***	0.138***	0.280***	-0.129***
	(0.024)	(0.020)	(0.020)	(0.024)
Conservative stance × Alignment	-0.068**	0.032	-0.270***	0.163***
	(0.024)	(0.021)	(0.020)	(0.023)
Baseline mean (Control)	0.656	0.212	0.499	0.303
Fixed-effects				
Issue FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fit statistics				
Observations	2,308	2,308	2,308	2,308
R^2	0.020	0.039	0.129	0.042

Significance codes: $^{***}p < 0.001$, $^{**}p < 0.01$, $^{*}p < 0.05$, $^{\dagger}p < 0.1$.

C Pre-Analysis Plan: Clarifications and Deviations

This appendix documents the relationship between the pre-analysis plan (PAP) registered on June 11, 2025 and the analysis reported in the paper. I note any clarifications of ambiguities in the PAP and any cases where the analysis deviates from or extends the registered design.

C.1 Third Issue Domain

The PAP's Motivation and Overview section describes the three political issues as "abortion rights, diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) programs in the workplace, and responses to the January 6, 2021 insurrection." This was an editing error in the overview paragraph. The Summary of Treatment section of the same PAP—which specifies the nine vignette conditions—correctly lists transgender rights as the third issue, and the fielded survey used transgender rights throughout. The paper's use of "transgender equality" as the third issue domain is consistent with the actual registered and fielded design.

C.2 Political Awareness

The PAP states that the political awareness index is constructed from "six questions from ANES," describing five standard political knowledge items and a sixth based on respondents' ability to place the Democratic and Republican parties on a left-right spectrum. In the fielded survey, the index was constructed from five items only. The index used in the paper and in Appendix B.8 is therefore based on five items, not six. This was an error in the PAP. The construction of the index is otherwise exactly as registered: each item is coded as correct or incorrect, and I take the average across all five to form a continuous index that is then dichotomized at the median to define high and low awareness subgroups.

The PAP pre-registered a directional prediction that lower-awareness respondents would exhibit stronger responses to corporate political stances, consistent with theories of cue-taking among less engaged citizens (Kam, 2005). As discussed in Appendix B.8, this prediction was not confirmed: treatment effects are concentrated among high-awareness respondents. Although this result contradicts the pre-registered directional prediction, it is theoretically coherent and, in an important sense, reassuring about the validity of the underlying mechanism. This interpretation is also consistent with the external validity of the paper's findings more broadly—the white-collar workers who are the primary subject of Study 1 are, on average, likely to be more politically aware than the general survey population, suggesting the survey estimates may if anything be conservative.

C.3 Pre-Registered Outcomes Not Yet Reported

The PAP pre-registers three sets of outcomes that are not reported in the current version of the paper: (1) petition outcomes (willingness to sign a petition supporting a given political issue, and the alignment-weighted petition variable); (2) attitudinal outcomes (willingness to apply to the firm, motivation to work hard, and likelihood of leaving); and (3) cross-partisan giving (donations to organizations with whom the respondent is politically misaligned). These analyses were conducted as registered and will be reported in a follow-up study.